

Reading and Writing English — Study Notes with PYQ

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Subject: Reading and Writing English | **Coverage:** Blocks 1–6, 24 Units (Theory Only)

Source: Self Learning Material (SLM) — SGOU B21EG01LC

About These Notes

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These notes were created for my personal study and revision. I am sharing them here because someone else might find them useful too.

These notes follow the SGOU SLM B21EG01LC structure. Each topic has **Theory, Important Points, For Exam, and Previously Asked Questions** (PYQ number + year + marks). Related subsections are merged into tables where possible to keep revision fast. Where the SLM uses figures, a text description is included (refer your textbook for diagrams).

Wishing you all success in your semester exams and English language journey. Stay disciplined, revise smartly, and keep confidence in your effort, in sha Allah.

Dua mein Yaad Rakhna.

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(Detailed subsection numbers match SGOU SLM — see each unit heading in the notes.)

Block 1: Glimpses of Communication

Unit 1: Introduction to Communication

1.1.1 Communication

Theory

Communication (Latin *communicare* = to share) is the process of exchanging information between individuals using a common system of symbols, signs, gestures or behaviour. Aristotle called man “a social animal” — communication is foundational to collective human existence. The basic model features **Sender** → **Message** → **Receiver** → **Feedback**. Feedback is necessary for communication to continue; it becomes the next message in a two-way process. Human communication evolved from gestures and sounds to language, writing (cuneiform, hieroglyphs, papyrus), paper (China), printing, photography, telegraph, fax, radio, television and internet — connecting the world as a global village.

Important Points

- **Sender:** person who initiates communication and produces the message
- **Receiver:** processes and understands the message; sends feedback
- **Two-way process:** both parties participate actively; feedback becomes the next message (e.g. coffee shop order dialogue)
- History milestones: **paper** (China), **printing**, photography, telegraph, fax, radio, TV, internet
- Ancient writing: cuneiform, hieroglyphs, papyrus; homing pigeons used for messages (last pigeon-post service in Odisha, India)

- Even a slight facial expression can convey meaning — communication is continuous in human life

For Exam

Communication is the exchange of information using shared symbols between sender and receiver with feedback. **Primary purpose:** to exchange information, ideas and feelings between sender and receiver. It is a two-way process requiring active participation. The Latin origin is *communicare* (to share). Key milestones in its history include paper and printing (*also telegraph, radio, TV, internet*). The basic model: sender produces message, receiver decodes and responds with feedback, continuing the cycle.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q1** (1 mark, Aug 2023) — Name two inventions that were milestones in the field of communication.
- **Q54** (1 mark, Apr 2025) — What is the primary purpose of communication?

1.1.2 Types of Communication

Theory

Communication is classified by the **flow of information**. One-way communication sends information from sender to receiver without feedback — reading a book is an example. Two-way (interpersonal) communication involves both parties transmitting information, as in instant messaging or conversation.

Important Points

- **One-way:** sender → receiver, no feedback scope (reading a book, some broadcasts)
- **Two-way / Interpersonal:** both sender and receiver transmit information
- **Symmetric two-way:** equal parties — conversation between friends
- **Asymmetric two-way:** one party has more power — teacher lecturing, boss giving orders
- Example — symmetric: two friends chatting equally; asymmetric: employee listens while manager instructs

For Exam

Types of communication by flow: one-way (no feedback, e.g. reading) and two-way/interpersonal (both parties involved). Two-way is further divided into

symmetric (equal power) and asymmetric (dominant/subordinate relationship). Communication requires feedback in two-way exchanges for effectiveness.

1.1.2.1 Flow of Information

Theory

The **flow of information** determines whether communication allows feedback. One-way flows from sender to receiver only; two-way enables dialogue and correction of misunderstandings.

Important Points

- **One-way:** sender → receiver; no feedback scope — reading a book, some announcements
- **Two-way (interpersonal):** both parties transmit — conversation, instant messaging, interview
- **Symmetric:** equal parties — friends conversing on equal terms
- **Asymmetric:** power imbalance — teacher lecturing, manager instructing employee
- Feedback in two-way communication becomes the next message in the cycle
- One-way without feedback: reading a book (you are receiver, author is sender, no direct reply)

For Exam

Flow of information: one-way (no feedback) and two-way/interpersonal (both parties). Two-way divides into symmetric (equal) and asymmetric (unequal power). Feedback is necessary for continued two-way communication.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q2** (1 mark, Aug 2023) — What are the types of two way communication?
- **Q31** (1 mark, May 2024) — Give an example of asymmetric communication.
- **Q60** (1 mark, Oct 2025) — Give an example of a symmetric two-way communication.

1.1.3 Methods of Communication

Theory

Methods describe the **channel** through which messages travel. **Verbal communication** uses language in spoken/oral or written forms. **Non-verbal communication** relays messages without words, often enriching verbal messages through visual/symbolic and physical means.

Important Points

- **Verbal — Oral:** spoken word — face-to-face, telephone, interviews, speeches, debates, voice notes
- **Verbal — Written:** email, texts, letters, reports, SMS, social media posts, documents, handbooks
- **Non-verbal — Visual/Symbolic:** symbols, drawings, placards, traffic lights, illustrations
- **Non-verbal — Physical:** gestures, body language, facial expressions, tone, posture, touch, gaze, eye contact, proxemics
- Non-verbal often **supplements** verbal communication; a firm handshake conveys cordiality across cultures
- Written communication is generally more formal than oral; organisational communication follows set formats
- **Who relies on language (Q55):** Human beings / Humans

For Exam

Methods of communication are verbal and non-verbal. Verbal includes oral (spoken — face-to-face, phone) and written (email, letters, reports). Non-verbal includes visual/symbolic (traffic symbols) and physical (gestures, body language, tone, posture, proxemics). Non-verbal communication frequently enhances verbal messages. **Humans** rely on language for communication.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q55** (1 mark, Apr 2025) — Who relies on language for communication?

1.1.4 Major Styles of Communication

Theory

Communication styles reflect how a person expresses feelings and handles disagreement. Four major styles appear in the SLM: aggressive, passive,

passive-aggressive and assertive. Only assertive style balances self-expression with respect for others and allows healthy feedback.

Important Points

- **Aggressive:** raised voice, shouting, domination, threatening, bullying — ineffective; no scope for feedback
- **Passive:** accepts silently despite disagreement — lack of confidence; may cause long-term stress and anger build-up
- **Passive-Aggressive:** appears passive but expresses disagreement subtly — sulking, rumours, silent treatment, back-handed compliments
- **Assertive (most effective):** expresses own needs while considering others; clear, confident; no domination/subordination
- Assertive example: "I understand your point, but I disagree because the deadline is too short."
- Passive example: boss says "work overtime" — employee says "Okay" despite disagreement

For Exam

Four communication styles: aggressive (domination, bullying — ineffective), passive (silent acceptance — lack of confidence), passive-aggressive (subtle resentment), and assertive (most effective — clear expression with consideration for others). Assertive communication shows confidence and reduces misunderstanding.

1.1.4.1 Communication Styles — Comparison

Theory

The four communication styles differ in expression, confidence and effectiveness. Assertive style balances self-expression with respect for others and is the only style that supports healthy two-way feedback.

Important Points

Style	Characteristics	Example	Effectiveness
Aggressive	Raised voice, domination, bullying, threatening	School bully shouting	Ineffective; no feedback

Style	Characteristics	Example	Effectiveness
Passive	Silent acceptance despite disagreement	Employee says "Okay" to unfair overtime	Unhealthy; builds stress
Passive-Aggressive	Surface calm, hidden resentment	Sulking, rumours, silent treatment	Damages relationships
Assertive	Clear, confident, considers others	"I disagree because the deadline is too short"	Most effective

- Assertive shows confidence without dominating others
- Passive common in patriarchal societies where girls taught to remain silent
- Passive-aggressive persons seem cooperative but are resentful
- Bullying exemplifies **aggressive** style (exam answer)

For Exam

Four styles: aggressive (bullying — ineffective), passive (lack of confidence), passive-aggressive (subtle disagreement) and assertive (most effective). Assertive communication expresses needs clearly while respecting others, enabling healthy feedback and reducing misunderstanding.

1.1.5 Encoding and Decoding

Theory

Human language is symbolic. **Encoding** is the sender's process of converting thoughts or ideas into symbols or codes before transmission. **Decoding** is the receiver's process of interpreting those codes to extract meaning. Shared language and symbols are essential for successful communication.

Important Points

- **Encoding:** sender converts ideas into verbal or graphic symbols (e.g. red roses = love)
- **Decoding:** receiver interprets symbols to understand meaning
- Encoding example: A gives red roses to B → roses encode love; B decodes the symbol
- Decoding failure: tourist asks directions in English; pedestrian does not understand → communication fails

- If receiver cannot decode, communication becomes ineffective regardless of sender's intent
- Symbols include words, gestures, objects and cultural signs understood by both parties

For Exam

Encoding is the sender's conversion of thoughts into symbols before transmission; decoding is the receiver's interpretation of those symbols. Example: red roses encode love; the receiver must decode the symbol. If the receiver lacks the shared code (e.g. different language), decoding fails and communication is ineffective.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q10** (1 mark, Aug 2023) — What is encoding?
- **Q16** (1 mark, May 2024) — What is Decoding?
- **Q87** (2 marks, May 2024) 🔥 — In the process of communication who does the encoding and who does the decoding?

Unit Recap (from SLM)

- Communication = Latin *communicare* (to share); sender → message → receiver → feedback
- History: gestures → oral → written → print → visual → IT
- Styles: aggressive, passive, passive-aggressive, assertive
- Types: one-way, two-way (symmetric, asymmetric); encoding, decoding

Unit 2: Different Forms and Techniques of Communication

1.2.1 Different Forms of Communication

Theory

Communication forms are classified by **channel**, **style** and **number of participants**. Effective communication skills are essential for professional success. Modern informal communication (social media, texting) sometimes reduces awareness of professional norms, yet strong skills remain critical in the workplace.

Important Points

- **By channel — Verbal:** Oral (spoken) and Written (email, letters, reports)
- **By channel — Nonverbal:** body language, facial expressions, tone, haptics, proxemics, chronemics, vocalics/paralanguage
- **By style — Formal/Official:** pre-defined channels; rigid, systematic, documented; flows vertical, horizontal, diagonal
- **By style — Informal/Grapevine:** no fixed channels; spontaneous, fast; workplace coffee-break talk
- **By participants — Intrapersonal:** with oneself (diary, self-talk, remembering)
- **By participants — Dyadic:** two persons (telephone call between friends)
- **By participants — Small group, Public, Mass communication**
- Mass communication uses technology (radio, TV); limited feedback due to mediation
- Formal vertical: employee → manager → MD; horizontal: student → class monitor; diagonal: Principal → all students

For Exam

Communication forms include verbal (oral/written) and non-verbal channels; formal (official, documented, vertical/horizontal/diagonal flows) and informal (grapevine); and by participants: intrapersonal, dyadic, small group, public and mass. Dyadic = two participants. Informal workplace network = grapevine communication.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q105** (2 marks, Apr 2025) — What are the primary forms of communication?
- **Q201** (10 marks, Oct 2025) 🔥 — Explain the different forms of communication.

1.2.1.1 Verbal and Non-verbal Channels

Theory **Verbal communication** uses language orally or in writing. **Non-verbal communication** relies on external aspects — body language, symbols, appearance — and is often more spontaneous than words. It is most effective as a supplement to verbal communication.

Important Points

- **Oral examples:** face-to-face, telephone, interviews, speeches, meetings, debates, lectures, group discussions
- **Written examples:** letters, minutes, reports, notices, memos, emails, instant messaging
- **Paralanguage/Vocalics:** how something is said — pitch, tone, hesitation sounds — not the words themselves
- **Kinesics:** body movements and gestures as non-verbal communication
- **Proxemics:** role of space (sitting front row = interest in lecture)
- **Chronemics:** role of time (arriving late to interview = bad impression)
- **Haptics:** role of touch (hug when sad = comfort)
- Handshake = effective non-verbal supplement; firm yet warm handshake creates good impression

For Exam

Verbal communication is oral or written. Non-verbal includes paralanguage/vocalics (tone, pitch), kinesics (gestures), proxemics (space), chronemics (time) and haptics (touch). Non-verbal communication supplements verbal messages and is often more spontaneous and accurate in expressing mood.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q32** (1 mark, May 2024) — How can communication be classified on the basis of channel used?
- **Q33** (1 mark, May 2024) — What is proxemics?
- **Q115** (2 marks, Oct 2025) — What is paralanguage?
- **Q162** (5 marks, Apr 2025) — Explain the key aspects of verbal communication.
- **Q173** (5 marks, Oct 2025) 🔥 — Explain the different elements of non-verbal communication.
- **Q189** (10 marks, May 2024) 🔥 — Why is Nonverbal communication stronger than any other forms of communication?

1.2.1.2 Formal and Informal Communication

Theory

Based on **style and purpose**, communication is formal (official) or informal (grapevine). Formal communication follows pre-defined channels and produces documented records; informal communication is spontaneous and flexible.

Important Points

- **Formal/Official:** rigid, systematic, slow; pre-defined channels; documented; vertical, horizontal, diagonal flows
- **Vertical flow:** upper ↔ lower levels — employee reports to manager (upward); manager instructs (downward)
- **Horizontal flow:** same level — student discusses with class monitor
- **Diagonal flow:** across levels — Principal addresses all students and teachers directly
- **Informal/Grapevine:** no fixed channels; stretches all directions; mostly oral; spontaneous and fast
- Workplace coffee-break conversation = informal; official memo = formal written
- School example: student → monitor → tutor → Principal = vertical; peer discussion = horizontal

For Exam

Formal communication uses pre-defined channels with vertical, horizontal and diagonal flows. Informal communication (grapevine) has no fixed channels, is spontaneous and fast. Formal produces documented records; informal is mostly oral among peers.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q61** (1 mark, Oct 2025) — The communication that happens between friends at a workplace during a coffee brea...

1.2.1.3 Communication by Number of Participants

Theory

Communication is also classified by how many people participate — from intrapersonal (self) through dyadic, small group, public to mass communication.

Important Points

- **Intrapersonal:** within oneself — diary, self-reflection, remembering; aids self-development and stress management
- **Dyadic:** two persons — positions of source and receiver interchange; feedback becomes next message; telephone call between friends
- **Small group:** more than two — office meeting; formal or informal; shared goals and decision-making
- **Public communication:** one source, many receivers — speeches, lectures; used in education, politics, PR
- **Mass communication:** huge audience via technology — radio, TV, newspapers; limited feedback
- Dyadic = **two** participants (exam answer)

For Exam

By participants: intrapersonal (self), dyadic (two persons), small group, public (one-to-many) and mass communication (technology-mediated, limited feedback). Dyadic communication involves two participants with interchangeable roles.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q142** (5 marks, May 2024) — What are the different types of communication based on the number of participants?

1.2.2 Techniques of Effective Communication

Theory

Certain qualities and techniques improve communication effectiveness. The SLM lists curiosity, enthusiasm, empathy, honesty, humour, positivity, clarity and careful word choice. Mirroring and active listening strengthen interpersonal exchanges.

Important Points

- **Develop curiosity:** observe good communicators; read widely; listen actively
- **Display enthusiasm:** avoid poker face; maintain eye contact; ask open-ended questions
- **Be empathetic:** feel others' feelings; ego suspension; mirroring = subtle imitation of speaker's gestures

- **Reflect honesty:** honest people communicate effortlessly
- **Polish sense of humour:** politically correct, suitable, harmless jokes
- **Positivity:** smile more; manage stress; stay approachable
- **Clarity:** messages should leave no scope for misunderstanding
- **Careful choice of words:** avoid filler words — oh, umm, so, right
- **Mirroring:** subtle imitation of speaker's gestures builds rapport
- **Rhetoric:** the art of effective or persuasive speaking and writing (*PYQ Q34*)
- **7 Cs (exam useful):** Clear, Correct, Complete, Concise, Concrete, Courteous, Considerate

For Exam

Techniques for effective communication include developing curiosity, displaying enthusiasm, being empathetic (with mirroring), reflecting honesty, using appropriate humour, maintaining positivity, ensuring clarity and choosing words carefully. Avoid filler words (oh, right, so). Mirroring = subtle imitation of speaker's gestures. **Rhetoric** is the art of effective or persuasive speaking and writing.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q34** (1 mark, May 2024) — What is rhetoric?
- **Q86** (2 marks, May 2024) — Define the term Empathy.
- **Q106** (2 marks, Apr 2025) — What techniques enhance effective communication?
- **Q163** (5 marks, Apr 2025) — Discuss the techniques of effective communication.

Unit Recap (from SLM)

- Verbal (oral/written) and non-verbal forms
- Formal flows: vertical, horizontal, diagonal; informal = grapevine
- Haptics (touch), proxemics (space), chronemics (time), vocalics (paralanguage)
- Techniques: curiosity, enthusiasm, empathy, honesty, humour, positivity, clarity

Unit 3: Barriers to and Guidelines for Effective Communication

1.3.1 Barriers to Communication

Theory

Effective communication occurs when the message reaches the receiver without loss or change in meaning. **Barriers** prevent this. Identifying and removing barriers improves communication skills in personal and professional contexts.

Important Points

- **Physical barriers:** defective equipment, noise, closed doors, distance between sender and receiver
- **Physiological barriers:** biological conditions (dyslexia, nerve disorders, ADHD) affecting composition/reception
- **Psychological barriers:** prejudice, lack of trust, lack of attention, poor retention
- **Linguistic/Semantic barriers:** poor clarity, dialects, jargon, same word different meanings, wrong translation
- **Perceptual barriers:** different perceptions based on education, occupation, age; **stereotypes** = fixed wrong ideas about a group
- **Cultural barriers:** lack of awareness of other cultures; different cultural responses
- **Organisational barriers:** policies, rules, restrictions in institutions
- **Gender barriers:** gender-based communication differences
- **Emotional barriers:** stress, anger, fear affecting message delivery/reception
- **Mechanical/Technological barriers:** outdated machines, equipment failure
- **Lingo:** specialised vocabulary or jargon used by a particular group or profession — informal word for jargon (PYQ Q3)
- Jargon / lingo example: *myocardial infarction* vs heart attack — patient may not understand medical term
- Physical example: phone call at noisy railway station — noise interferes with message

- **Physical barriers (list):** noise, distance, poor network, environmental distractions, physical disabilities, faulty equipment, poor lighting, closed doors, time zones, geographical separation
- **Cultural barriers:** different customs, values, beliefs, language differences, non-verbal differences (gestures, eye contact), ethnocentrism, lack of cultural awareness
- **Filter:** avoiding certain topics in formal communication

For Exam

Ten barrier types: physical, physiological, psychological, linguistic/semantic, perceptual, cultural, organisational, gender, emotional, and mechanical/technological. **Lingo** = specialised vocabulary/jargon of a group (informal jargon). Jargon creates linguistic barriers. Dialects are language variations. Stress is an emotional barrier. Institutional rules create organisational barriers. Stereotypes are perceptual barriers.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q3** (1 mark, Aug 2023) — What is Lingo?
- **Q62** (1 mark, Oct 2025, May 2024) ★ — Physiological barriers refer to biological conditions like dyslexia that affect co...
- **Q94** (2 marks, May 2024) — What is Dyslexia?
- **Q125** (5 marks, Aug 2023, Oct 2025) ★🔥 — What are the physical barriers to communication? List them.
- **Q135** (5 marks, Aug 2023) — What are dialects? Give examples.
- **Q155** (5 marks, May 2024) — What are the cultural barriers to communication?
- **Q161** (5 marks, Apr 2025) 🔥 — Discuss the various barriers to effective communication.
- **Q174** (5 marks, Oct 2025) 🔥 — Elucidate on the physical and physiological barriers to communication.
- **Q191** (10 marks, May 2024) 🔥 — What are the greatest challenges in effective communication?

1.3.1.1–1.3.1.3 Barrier Categories — Overview

Theory

Barriers group into environmental/physical, personal/psychological and language/cultural categories. Understanding categories helps identify appropriate solutions for each barrier type.

Important Points

Category	Barrier Types	Example	Solution
Environmental	Physical, Mechanical/Technological	Noise at railway station; outdated phone	Reduce noise; upgrade equipment
Personal	Physiological, Psychological, Emotional, Perceptual	Dyslexia; stress; stereotypes	Patience; emotion management; avoid labelling
Language/Cultural	Linguistic/Semantic, Cultural, Organisational, Gender	Jargon; cultural norms; institutional rules	Simple language; cultural awareness; follow protocol
Filtering	Avoiding topics in formal talk	Deliberately skipping sensitive subjects	Develop appropriate filter for context

- **Labelling/Stereotyping:** forming a fixed, often unfair idea about a person or group — perceptual barrier
- **Labelling example:** assuming all elderly people are bad at technology
- **Filter:** knowing what **not** to say in formal communication — avoiding offensive or prejudiced topics
- Overcoming barriers: active listening, feedback, simple language, empathy, cultural sensitivity

For Exam

Communication barriers are physical (noise, distance), physiological (dyslexia), psychological (prejudice), linguistic (jargon/lingo, dialects), perceptual (stereotypes/labelling), cultural, organisational (rules), gender, emotional (stress) and mechanical (outdated equipment). Labelling = fixed unfair idea about a group (e.g. elderly people and technology). Active listening and cultural awareness help overcome barriers.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q97** (2 marks, May 2024) — What is meant by labelling? Give an example.

1.3.2 Guidelines for Effective Communication

Theory

Guidelines help overcome barriers and strengthen communication. **Active listening** — fully concentrating, understanding and responding — is central. Non-verbal awareness, public speaking practice, emotion management and honest feedback all support effective exchange.

Important Points

- **Active/Reflective listening:** engage with speaker; give affirmative replies; ask follow-up questions; understand before responding
- **Non-verbal communication:** observe facial expressions and body language; maintain eye contact; good posture creates positive impression
- **Public speaking practice:** builds confidence; overcomes fear; provides feedback to improve
- **Clarity and simplicity:** be clear and simple; be respectful and polite
- **Emotion management:** express emotions at appropriate time; watch tone; uncontrolled anger/sadness hinders delivery
- **Honest feedback:** listen to friends/colleagues; be open to suggestions
- **Develop a filter:** avoid prejudices, offensive topics in formal settings — know what not to say
- Active listening example: nodding, saying "I see", asking "Can you explain more?"
- Stereotype example (perceptual): assuming educated people are always more intelligent

For Exam

Guidelines for effective communication: active listening, non-verbal awareness, public speaking practice, clarity and simplicity, emotion management, honest feedback and developing a filter for formal contexts. Active listening confirms understanding and completes the communication cycle. Body language and good posture are non-verbal tools.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q21** (1 mark, May 2024) — What does it mean to be an active listener?
- **Q145** (5 marks, May 2024) — Why is listening skills an essential part of communication?
- **Q197** (10 marks, Apr 2025) 🔥 — How would you describe good/effective communication? Discuss its key aspects, diff...

Unit Recap (from SLM)

- Barriers: physical, physiological, psychological, linguistic, perceptual, cultural, organisational, gender, emotional, mechanical
 - Jargon, dialects, stereotypes, filters hinder communication
 - Active listening, non-verbal skills, public speaking, emotion management improve effectiveness
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Block 2: Reading: The Effective Skill

Unit 1: Introduction to Reading

2.1.2 Nature of Reading and Literacy

Theory

Reading opens windows to worlds outside the reader's experience and reflects the world they already know. It prepares students for personal challenges and moral dilemmas. Most young students begin with narrative texts (storybooks) and informational texts. Fiction reading differs from prescribed academic reading — readers may skip portions when reading for pleasure.

Important Points

- Reading prepares for real-world challenges and moral dilemmas beyond employment skills
- **Young students:** narrative texts (storybooks) and informational texts in early years
- **Fiction reading nature:** may skip sentences, paragraphs or pages to finish faster

- Prescribed academic reading requires close, thorough attention — different from amusive reading
- Biography uniquely serves **both informational and literary purposes**
- Literacy reading reasons: pleasure, learning, social participation
- **Two broad categories of reading (PYQ Q76):**
 - **Extensive reading** — reading widely/large amounts for general understanding and habit
 - **Intensive reading** — detailed, careful study of shorter texts for full comprehension
- *(Exam may also accept: Reading for study vs Reading for pleasure)*

For Exam

Most young students read narrative and informational texts. Fiction reading allows skipping portions unlike prescribed academic reading. Biography serves both informational and literary purposes. **Two broad categories:** extensive reading (wide reading for general understanding) and intensive reading (detailed study of shorter texts). Also framed as reading for study vs reading for pleasure.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q76** (2 marks, Aug 2023) — What are the two broad categories of reading?

2.1.1 Different Purposes of Reading

Theory

Reading is the intellectual process of **decoding** a text and understanding its abstract meaning (ideas, perspectives, emotions). The writer **encodes** abstract ideas into language; the reader decodes using shared language. We read for different purposes using different methods — newspapers for information, articles for ideas, academic books for knowledge, fiction for pleasure, reference books for specific facts.

Important Points

- **Newspapers:** daily information and happenings
- **Articles:** ideas and perspectives
- **Academic books:** knowledge and study

- **Fiction:** pleasure and literary experience; may skip portions to finish faster
- **Reference books/encyclopaedia:** specific information — requires careful, repeated reading
- **Primary purpose of reading (Q59):** to decode text and understand its meaning (ideas, perspectives, emotions)
- **Two purposes (Q18):** for information / for pleasure (*also: to learn, to entertain, for study*)
- **Close reading:** explication of text — detailed analysis; asks *how* meaning is created (John Ciardi — *How Does a Poem Mean?*)
- **Biography:** serves both informational and literary purposes
- Young students read narrative texts (storybooks) and informational texts
- Start essay analysis with **larger ideas**; use small details to support interpretation

For Exam

Reading = decoding text to absorb abstract meaning — that is its **primary purpose**. Two common purposes: information and pleasure. Newspapers provide information; articles provide ideas and perspectives. Close reading is explication of text (John Ciardi). Biography serves both informational and literary purposes. Fiction offers literary experience; instructional texts convey information.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q18** (1 mark, May 2024) — Mention two purposes of reading.
- **Q59** (1 mark, Apr 2025) — What is the primary purpose of reading?

Unit Recap (from SLM)

- Reading = decoding; purposes vary by text type
- Newspapers (info), articles (ideas), fiction (pleasure), reference (facts)
- Close reading = explication; John Ciardi; start with larger ideas

Unit 2: Types of Reading

2.2.1 Skimming

Theory Skimming is fast reading, sometimes skipping portions, for general comprehension or appreciation. It helps judge whether a book deserves closer reading. Speed reading assists when a book suits only a quick read. Skimming is used in fiction and news stories.

Important Points

- Pre-read to judge book's worth: title, preface, contents, index, pivotal chapters
- Goal: determine if closer reading is necessary; still yields overview of structure
- Used for fiction, news stories, deciding relevance of unfamiliar books
- Many books are not worth even skimming — selective reading saves time
- Skimming example: read title, contents, index, chapter summaries → decide if worth detailed study

For Exam

Skimming is fast reading for general comprehension, sometimes skipping portions. Used in fiction and news stories. Pre-read by checking title, preface, contents and index. If unsure about a book's relevance, skim first.

2.2.1–2.2.2 Skimming vs Scanning — Comparison

Theory

Skimming and scanning are both fast reading techniques but serve different purposes. Skimming provides overview; scanning locates specific information. When unsure a text contains needed data, skim first then scan.

Important Points

Feature	Skimming	Scanning
Purpose	General comprehension, gist, overview	Find specific information
Speed	Fast; may skip portions	Fast; eyes jump to keywords
Coverage	Title, preface, contents, index, pivotal chapters	Relevant lines only
Example	Previewing textbook before purchase	Dictionary lookup for a word

Feature	Skimming	Scanning
When unsure	Skim first to check relevance	Scan after skimming confirms usefulness
Used in	Fiction, news stories	User manuals, research, dictionaries

- Skimming = bird's-eye view; Scanning = search engine approach
- Close reading is **reverse** of skimming — thorough, no skipping
- If book may not contain needed details → **skim first** (exam answer)

For Exam

Skimming gives general overview (fiction, news); scanning finds specific information (dictionary). Skimming checks relevance; scanning extracts targeted data. If unsure about content, skim first. Close reading is the reverse of skimming.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q144** (5 marks, May 2024, Oct 2025) ★🔥 — What is the difference between Skimming and Scanning?
- **Q175** (5 marks, Oct 2025) — Differentiate between skimming and scanning with examples.

2.2.2 Scanning

Theory**Scanning** searches quickly for specific information without reading the whole text. Eyes move fast and pause on relevant lines. Dictionary lookup and user manuals are classic examples. If unsure the book contains needed data, skim first then scan.

Important Points

- Four steps: (1) know what to find (2) one keyword at a time (3) eyes scan quickly (4) read thoroughly around found keyword
- Examples: dictionary lookup, user manual, finding a date or name in a document
- Uses structural hints: headings, tables of contents, indexes, typographic clues

- Objective differs from skimming: scanning finds specific data; skimming gives bird's-eye view
- Scanning example: eyes jump to dictionary letter section, find "photosynthesis", read only that entry

For Exam

Scanning finds specific information quickly without reading entire text.

Example: referring to a dictionary. Steps: identify keyword, scan quickly, read surrounding text thoroughly. If unsure book contains needed info, skim first then scan.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q99** (2 marks, May 2024) — Define scanning method of reading with an example.

2.2.3 Close Reading / Thorough Reading

Theory **Close reading** reads the entire text without skipping, with keen attention to every word and punctuation mark. It is the reverse of skimming and enables critical analysis. Prescribed texts and important articles require close reading. John Ciardi's *How Does a Poem Mean?* emphasises explication over mere summary.

Important Points

- **Step 1 — Read thoroughly:** identify theme, characters, action, context; ask what is happening
- **Step 2 — Understand patterns:** organisation, recurring themes, literary devices, word choice
- **Step 3 — Reread the passage:** connect patterns to overall meaning
- Reverse of skimming; demands intense concentration; usually on short passages
- Enables critical analysis — explains *how* author creates meaning, not just *what*
- Active reading is the best form of reading

For Exam

Close reading is thorough reading without skipping — reverse of skimming —

enabling critical analysis. Three steps: read thoroughly, understand patterns and methods, reread the passage. Active reading is the best form of reading.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q164** (5 marks, Apr 2025, Aug 2023) ★🔥 — Describe the different types of reading.
- **Q188** (10 marks, Aug 2023, Oct 2025) ★🔥 — Explain the different types of reading and their significance.

2.2.3.1 Close Reading Step 1 — Read Thoroughly

Theory

The first close reading pass establishes basic understanding — theme, characters, action and context. For a novel passage, ask what is happening and who is involved.

Important Points

- Identify central theme or message of the passage
- Note characters: who they are, what they look like, how they behave
- Track action: what is happening; do characters speak or move?
- Place passage in overall narrative context if full text is known
- Do not analyse deeply on first read — build foundation understanding

For Exam

Close reading Step 1: read thoroughly to grasp theme, characters, action and context. Ask what the passage is about, who is involved and what happens. Build foundation before pattern analysis.

2.2.3.2 Close Reading Step 2 — Patterns and Methods

Theory

The second pass examines how the text is constructed — organisation, recurring themes, literary devices and word choice. John Ciardi's purpose of close reading is to **explicate** the text — to explain *how* the poem/text means, not just *what* it says (*How Does a Poem Mean?*).

Important Points

- How has the text been organised? Chronological? Thematic? Argumentative?
- Recurring themes, keywords or phrases — why might the author repeat them?
- Literary devices: metaphor, simile, irony, symbolism, alliteration, imagery
- Word choice (diction): formal vs informal; connotations of specific words
- Sentence structure: short vs long sentences; effect on pace and emphasis
- **John Ciardi (Q74):** purpose of close reading = to explicate — explain *how* a poem means
- **Lyric poetry:** expresses personal emotions and feelings of the poet; often musical; subjective and emotional
- **Poem vs Poetry:** **Poetry** = the literary art form/genre as a whole; **Poem** = a single individual composition within poetry
- **Imagery:** vivid descriptive language appealing to the senses (sight, sound, smell, taste, touch) that creates mental pictures; common in poetry
- **Simile:** direct comparison using **like** or **as** — “*O my luv is like a red, red rose*” = love compared to a rose (simile)
- **Denotation** = literal/dictionary meaning of a word; **Connotation** = emotional/cultural associations (e.g. *home* = warmth, not just a house)
- **Dramatic monologue:** a poem in which a single speaker addresses a silent listener, revealing character through speech
- **My Last Duchess (Robert Browning):** Duke shows visitor a portrait of his late wife; reveals jealousy, pride and control; implies he ordered her death — classic Victorian dramatic monologue

For Exam

Close reading Step 2: examine patterns and methods — organisation, recurring themes, literary devices and diction. John Ciardi: explicate *how* a text means. Lyric poetry = personal emotion. Poetry = genre; poem = one composition. Imagery = sensory mental pictures. Simile uses like/as. Denotation = dictionary meaning; connotation = associations. Dramatic monologue = one speaker, silent listener (e.g. Browning's *My Last Duchess*).

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q74** (1 mark, Oct 2025) — According to John Ciardi, what is the purpose of Close Reading?
- **Q77** (2 marks, Aug 2023) — What is lyric poetry?
- **Q78** (2 marks, Aug 2023) — Identify and define the figure of speech in "O my love is like a red, red rose/ Th...
- **Q116** (2 marks, Oct 2025) — Differentiate between denotation and connotation.
- **Q126** (5 marks, Aug 2023) — What is imagery?
- **Q129** (5 marks, Aug 2023) — What is a dramatic monologue? Explain it in the context of "My Last Duchess".
- **Q185** (10 marks, Aug 2023) — Analyse the following poem and prepare a note of appreciation. — Stopping by Woods on a Snowy Evening (Robert Frost)
- **Q192** (10 marks, May 2024) — Analyse the poem: Fire and Ice by Robert Frost.

2.2.3.3 Close Reading Step 3 — Reread the Passage

Theory

The third step integrates findings from Steps 1 and 2 through rereading, connecting patterns to overall meaning and preparing for critical analysis or exam answers.

Important Points

- Third step of close reading = **reread the passage** (exam answer)
- Connect patterns from Step 2 to theme from Step 1
- Formulate interpretation supported by textual evidence
- Prepare for essay or short-answer analysis using specific quotes and references
- Critical analysis needs close reading — cannot analyse what was skimmed

For Exam

Close reading Step 3 is rereading the passage to connect patterns with overall meaning. This enables critical analysis supported by textual evidence. Exam: third step = reread the passage.

2.2.3.4 Poem Appreciation — Robert Frost (Exam)

Theory

Section D often asks for a note of appreciation of a given poem. Two Robert Frost poems appear in PYQs: *Stopping by Woods on a Snowy Evening* and *Fire and Ice*. Use close-reading method: theme, summary, devices, famous lines.

Important Points

Stopping by Woods on a Snowy Evening (Q185)

- **Poet:** Robert Frost | **Form:** Lyric poem
- **Theme:** Duty vs desire; beauty of nature vs responsibilities of life
- **Summary:** Speaker stops in woods on a snowy evening; horse is puzzled; woods are lovely, dark and deep; but promises to keep and miles to go before sleep — chooses obligation over temptation
- **Symbolism:** woods = temptation/rest/death; snow = peace; horse = practical world
- **Appreciation:** simple language, deep meaning; repetition of last line emphasises life's burdens; rhyme scheme AABA BBCB CCDC DDDD
- **Famous lines:** "The woods are lovely, dark and deep" / "And miles to go before I sleep"

Fire and Ice (Q192)

- **Poet:** Robert Frost | **Form:** Short lyric / epigram
- **Theme:** Destruction of the world — by desire (fire) or hatred (ice)
- **Summary:** Some say world ends in fire, some in ice; from desire (fire) and hate (ice), both can destroy; hate (ice) would also suffice
- **Symbols:** **Fire** = desire, passion, greed; **Ice** = hatred, coldness, indifference
- **Appreciation:** metaphor for human emotions causing destruction; tone ironic and philosophical; 9 lines, irregular rhyme

For Exam — Appreciation template

Poet + form → theme → brief summary → devices/symbols → 1–2 famous lines → personal closing on significance. For Frost: nature/emotion metaphors, simple diction, philosophical depth.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q185** (10 marks, Aug 2023) — Analyse the following poem and prepare a note of appreciation. — *Stopping by Woods on a Snowy Evening* (Robert Frost)

- **Q192** (10 marks, May 2024) — Analyse the poem: Fire and Ice by Robert Frost.

2.2.4 Amusive Reading

Theory**Amusive reading** is reading for pleasure in free time. It relaxes the mind and builds reading habit without academic pressure. Novels, magazines and light fiction are typical amusive texts.

Important Points

- Reading for pleasure and recreation — not for examination or research
- Builds vocabulary and reading fluency indirectly
- Differs from prescribed academic close reading in pace and purpose
- Fiction reading may skip sentences or pages — acceptable in amusive context

For Exam

Amusive reading is pleasure reading in leisure time. It differs from academic close reading in purpose and pace. Fiction may be read quickly with skipped portions when reading for amusement.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q35** (1 mark, May 2024) — What is reading for pleasure called?

2.2.5 Reading Between the Lines

Theory**Reading between the lines** discovers hidden or implied meanings from textual suggestions and clues rather than explicit statements. It requires inference — understanding what the author implies without stating directly.

Important Points

- Discovers implied meanings from context, tone and suggestion
- Example: character says "Fine, whatever" but slams door → hidden anger despite calm words
- Used in literary analysis, comprehension passages and critical reading
- Combines textual evidence with reader's inference and world knowledge

For Exam

Reading between the lines means discovering hidden meanings from textual clues and suggestions. It requires inference beyond explicit statements.

Example: calm words combined with angry actions imply concealed emotion.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q88** (2 marks, May 2024) — What is the technique used to discover hidden meaning in text?

Unit Recap (from SLM)

- Types: skimming, scanning, close reading, amusive, reading between the lines
- Skimming = gist; scanning = specific info; close reading = no skipping
- Close reading 3 steps; active reading is best
- Literary exam terms: lyric, imagery, dramatic monologue, denotation/connotation
- Poem appreciation: Frost — *Stopping by Woods, Fire and Ice*

Unit 3: Reading Comprehension

2.3.1 What is Reading Comprehension

Theory

Reading comprehension requires both **speed** and **understanding** — fast reading without comprehension is useless; slow reading may prevent finishing required material. Good comprehension combines textual analysis with the reader's knowledge and emotional state.

Important Points

- Comprehension = understanding what is read, not merely recognising words
- Balance speed with accuracy — neither too fast nor too slow
- Makes reading enjoyable when skills are well developed
- Repeated reading of similar content generates variety of viewpoints

For Exam

Reading comprehension combines speed and understanding. Fast reading

without comprehension is ineffective. Good comprehension skills make reading enjoyable and support academic success.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q107** (2 marks, Apr 2025) — What is reading comprehension?

2.3.2 Skills for Reading Comprehension

Theory

Comprehension skills include word recognition, information retention, scanning backwards and forwards to relevant terms, and understanding signals from sentence structure and punctuation. **Annotation** — adding notes while reading — aids both fiction and nonfiction.

Important Points

- **Skills:** recognise words; retain information; scan back/forth; use punctuation and structure signals
- **Annotation:** notes/thoughts while reading — types differ for fiction and nonfiction
- **External factors:** general perspectives, emotional state influence comprehension
- **Main ideas vs supporting details:** distinguish central argument from evidence
- **Context clues:** discover meaning of new words from surrounding text
- Annotation example: "Jennie sprang bolt upright" → suddenly awakened; "tinny voice from bedside table" → radio/alarm

For Exam

Comprehension skills include word recognition, retention, scanning backwards/forwards and using punctuation signals. Annotation aids understanding. Distinguish main ideas from supporting details. Context clues reveal unfamiliar word meanings.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q138** (5 marks, May 2024) — Identify the basic requisites in Reading comprehension.

2.3.3 The Process of Interpretation

Theory

The **textbase method** identifies three levels of interpretation. The **situation model** integrates text meaning with the reader's general knowledge and personal feelings, leading to deepened understanding.

Important Points

- **Linguistic level:** recognise and analyse particular words and meanings
- **Microstructure level:** understand content of bigger sections of text
- **Macrostructure level:** recognise themes, topics and genre
- **Textbase:** all three levels together
- **Situation model:** reader integrates text with knowledge and feelings → deepened understanding
- Text + reader interaction produces richer meaning than text alone

For Exam

Three interpretation levels: linguistic (words), microstructure (sections), macrostructure (themes/genre) — together forming textbase. The situation model integrates text with reader's knowledge and feelings for deepened understanding. Scanning backwards/forwards is a vital comprehension competence.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q63** (1 mark, Oct 2025) — What is the model developed by a reader when he/she integrates the textual meaning...
- **Q98** (2 marks, May 2024) — What is textbase?
- **Q117** (2 marks, Oct 2025) — What is microstructure in interpretation?
- **Q150** (5 marks, May 2024) — Explain the process of interpretation.

Unit Recap (from SLM)

- Comprehension: speed + understanding; annotation; main vs supporting ideas
- Textbase: linguistic, microstructure, macrostructure
- Situation model integrates text with reader knowledge

Unit 4: Analysing Literature

2.4.1 “The Dream and the Message” by A.P.J. Abdul Kalam

Theory

Dr A.P.J. Abdul Kalam — “missile man of India,” President (2002–2007), author of *Wings of Fire*, *Ignited Minds* and others. *Ignited Minds* offers a roadmap for India’s future, motivating youth. “**The Dream and the Message**” is its first chapter. On 30 September 2001, Kalam’s helicopter crashed near Bokaro; he continued his student interaction programme. A tranquiliser led to a dream in a moonlit desert where five admired figures — Gandhi, Einstein, Asoka, Lincoln and Caliph Omar — discuss violence, division and humanity’s path forward.

Important Points

- **Book:** *Ignited Minds*; **Chapter 1:** “The Dream and the Message”
- **Primary focus of Chapter 1 (Q50):** Kalam’s dream after the helicopter crash (30 Sept 2001) and the message from five great thinkers on violence, division and youth empowerment through education
- **dream date:** 30 September 2001; **setting:** desert, moonlit
- **Five thinkers in dream:** Mahatma Gandhi, Albert Einstein, Emperor Asoka, Abraham Lincoln, Caliph Omar
- **Asoka:** merciless conqueror → compassionate ruler; Kalinga war — 300,000 lives; embraced Ahimsa and Dharma
- **Gandhi:** message of creation; coexistence across religions, races, languages; assimilate beauty into soul
- **Einstein:** West built ship without compass; Tagore and Gandhi found the compass for life’s purpose
- **Lincoln:** fought slavery; happiness through family prosperity and grace of God
- **Omar:** all men equal; government as sacred trust
- Kalam concludes: education with spiritual dimension solves destructive human tendencies

For Exam

“The Dream and the Message” (Chapter 1 of *Ignited Minds*) focuses on Kalam’s dream after his 30 September 2001 helicopter crash. In a desert, five great thinkers discuss violence and division. Kalam concludes that education combining material and spiritual dimensions can address humanity’s

destructive capacity. The chapter motivates Indian youth to ignite their minds for national development.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q29** (1 mark, May 2024) 🔥 — Name two books written by Dr. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam.
- **Q50** (1 mark, Apr 2025) — What is the primary focus of Chapter 1 in Ignited Minds?

2.4.1.1 Summary of "The Dream and the Message"

Theory

On 30 September 2001, Kalam's helicopter crashed minutes before landing at Bokaro; all escaped miraculously. After a tranquiliser, he dreams of a moonlit desert where Gandhi, Einstein, Asoka, Lincoln and Caliph Omar discuss humanity's divisions.

Important Points

- Helicopter crash on journey Ranchi to Bokaro; Kalam continued student programme unfazed
- Dream setting: desert, moonlight, five thinkers in a circle, clothes ruffling in wind
- **Asoka:** Kalinga war — 300,000 killed; embraced Ahimsa; victory causing suffering is no victory
- **Gandhi:** message of creation; coexistence across religions; assimilate beauty into soul
- **Einstein:** West's ship lacks compass; Tagore and Gandhi found life's compass
- **Lincoln:** fought slavery; happiness through family prosperity and grace of God
- **Omar:** all men equal in Jerusalem; government as sacred trust
- Kalam questions why Kalinga war, Gandhi's and Lincoln's assassinations occurred

For Exam

Summary: After helicopter crash (30 Sept 2001), Kalam dreams in a desert of

five thinkers discussing violence. Asoka reflects on Kalinga; Gandhi on coexistence; Einstein on life's compass; Lincoln on slavery; Omar on equality. The dream addresses division among humanity.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q103** (2 marks, May 2024) 🔥 — What are the thoughts of Abraham Lincoln in Kalam's imagined conversation?
- **Q159** (5 marks, May 2024) 🔥 — Explain the context of "The Dream and the Message".
- **Q194** (10 marks, May 2024) 🔥 — Elucidate on the thoughts of the great thinkers who appear in "The Dream and the M...

2.4.1.2 Analysis of "The Dream and the Message"

Theory

The chapter is seminal in *Ignited Minds*, entreating youth to innovate for a prosperous India. Kalam broods over chaos and violence after the accident, seeking clues from Gandhi, Lincoln, Asoka, Omar and Einstein. He advocates symbiosis of spiritual and material education to achieve peacefulness and recommends scientific temper with spirit of enquiry.

Important Points

- Genre: autobiographical essay / visionary narrative within memoir
- Tone: reflective, inspirational, nationalistic
- Central argument: destructive human capacity overcome through holistic education
- Symbolism: desert = barren conflict; moonlight = hope; circle of thinkers = universal wisdom
- Connection to Gandhi's message: needs vs greed; coexistence and non-violence
- Exam focus: dream context, five figures, education + spirituality as solution

For Exam

Literary analysis of Kalam's chapter examines how the dream narrative conveys India's need for youth empowerment through education blending material opportunity and spiritual values. Kalam uses historical figures as moral compasses. The essay motivates scientific temper and national service.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q137** (5 marks, May 2024) 🔥 — How does A P J Abdul Kalam inspire the youth through “The Dreams and the Message”?

2.4.2 “The Open Window” by H.H. Munro (Saki)

Theory

Hector Hugh Munro (Saki) was a Scottish author of plays, short stories and novels, writing with humour and satire targeting Edwardian English society.

“**The Open Window**” (1914, *Beasts and Super-Beasts*) is his most famous story. Nervous visitor **Framton Nuttel** meets fifteen-year-old **Vera**, who fabricates a tragic tale about her aunt’s husband and brothers dying in a bog. When the men return alive, Framton flees in terror; Vera calmly invents another story about his fear of dogs.

Important Points

- **Protagonist:** Vera (name = veracity/truth — ironically untruthful)
- **Visitor:** Framton Nuttel — nerve cure, formal visits, easily deceived
- **Plot twist:** Vera’s ghost story; hunters return through open window; Framton’s headlong retreat
- **Vera’s speciality:** “Romance at short notice” — expert storyteller
- Saki deceives readers as Vera deceives Framton — unreliable young narrator
- Munro subverts expectation that young women are trustworthy; Vera is cunning troublemaker

For Exam

Saki’s “The Open Window” features Vera, who tells Framton Nuttel a fabricated tragedy about hunters lost in a bog. When they return, he flees. Vera ironically embodies “veracity” but is anything but truthful. The story uses humour, irony and an unexpected conclusion.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q49** (1 mark, Apr 2025) 🔥 — Who is Vera in Munroe’s story?
- **Q127** (5 marks, Aug 2023, May 2024, Oct 2025) ★🔥 — Give a short character sketch of Vera.

- **Q176** (5 marks, Oct 2025) — Explain the significance of Vera's character in Munro's short-story.

2.4.2.1 A Close Reading of "The Open Window"

Theory

The narrative has three parts: Vera-Framton conversation, aunt's arrival, hunters' return. Munro uses flashbacks and story-within-a-story. Vera's portrayal as "romance at short notice" connects her to Saki himself as narrative authority.

Important Points

- Three-part structure: (1) Vera and Framton (2) Mrs Sappleton enters (3) hunters return
- Flashback technique: Vera's imagined past breaks present narrative
- Gender reversal: young girl as cunning deceiver, not innocent victim
- Childhood theme: Vera escapes dull adult world through imaginative storytelling
- Aunt as commanding presence; Vera flees through creative narrative
- Edwardian sitting-room parodied — "bustled," "whirl," "cheerfully" disrupt serene country setting

For Exam

Close reading reveals three narrative sections connected by Vera's fabricated flashback. Munro breaks assumptions about gender and age — Vera is a cunning storyteller. Childhood appears as escape from monotonous adult reality through imagination.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q108** (2 marks, Apr 2025) 🔥 — How does the author's use of language contribute to the atmosphere of "The Open Wi..."
- **Q146** (5 marks, May 2024) 🔥 — How does Vera prank Mr. Nuttel in the story 'The Open Window'?

2.4.2.2 Themes of "The Open Window"

Theory

Major themes include chaos vs order, desire to escape, impact of storytelling,

comedy and rural peace. Munro uses disorder to parody Edwardian conventions.

Important Points

- **Chaos vs Order:** wild bog, ghost story disrupt orderly sitting-room; open window admits turbulence
- **Desire to flee:** Vera escapes through imagination; Framton seeks rural cure but finds more turmoil
- **Storytelling as art:** Vera and Munro both deceive audiences; story-within-a-story structure
- **Comedy:** ironic twist; Framton's panic vs Vera's calm second fabrication
- **Childhood:** significant concept — imagination vs adult monotony
- **Rural peace subverted:** countryside setting turned gothic through Vera's tale

For Exam

Themes in "The Open Window" include chaos vs order, escape (Vera through imagination, Framton through countryside visit), storytelling's deceptive power, comedy and childhood. The open window symbolises the boundary between reality and fiction.

2.4.2.3 Window as a Symbol

Theory

The **window** functions as symbol and metaphor — a portal between reality and Vera's imagined world. It represents openness to deception and the boundary between inner and outer worlds.

Important Points

- Window = portal into alternate universe Vera creates through storytelling
- Open window admits both literal hunters and metaphorical chaos
- Boundary between reality (hunters alive) and fiction (Vera's tragedy)
- Symbol of escape from dull Edwardian adult existence
- Exam answer: window = symbol and metaphor in the story

For Exam

The window symbolises the boundary between reality and imagination. It is the

entry point for both Vera's fabricated tragedy and the hunters' return. As metaphor, it represents escape from monotonous adult life into creative alternate worlds.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q118** (2 marks, Oct 2025) 🔥 — What does the window in H.H. Munro's story symbolize?

2.4.3 "The Blessed Damozel" by Dante Gabriel Rossetti

Theory

Dante Gabriel Rossetti was a Pre-Raphaelite poet and painter. **"The Blessed Damozel"** tells of a young woman in heaven leaning over a golden bar, waiting for her earthly lover. Rich Christian imagery pervades the poem — heaven, stars, angels, the **white lily** symbolising Christ's resurrection. Themes include love, grief, religion and separation beyond death.

Important Points

- **Poet:** Dante Gabriel Rossetti; **Pre-Raphaelite** style — rich visual imagery
- **Setting:** heaven — Damozel at golden bar looking down at earth
- **White lily:** symbolises Christ's resurrection
- **Themes:** love transcending death, grief, religious faith, longing, separation
- Medieval and religious references throughout
- Exam theme: grief beyond death (also love, grief, religion)

For Exam

Rossetti's "The Blessed Damozel" depicts a woman in heaven waiting for her lover. Christian imagery includes the white lily (Christ's resurrection). Themes are love, grief and religion. The poem uses Pre-Raphaelite visual richness and medieval symbolism.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q51** (1 mark, Apr 2025) 🔥 — What is the central theme explored in "The Blessed Damozel" by Rossetti?

2.4.3.1 Summary of "The Blessed Damozel"

Theory

The poem presents a young woman in heaven leaning over a golden bar, looking down at her earthly lover who grieves below. She waits for him to join her, surrounded by angels and religious imagery.

Important Points

- Damozel in heaven, hair flowing, leaning on golden bar gazing earthward
- Her lover remains on earth — separation between heavenly and earthly realms
- **White lily** among her hair — symbolises Christ's resurrection
- Angels, stars, heaven, prayer — rich Christian imagery throughout
- Theme of love persisting beyond death; grief of separation
- Pre-Raphaelite visual style — detailed, medieval, sensuous imagery

For Exam

Summary: A damozel in heaven waits for her earthly lover, leaning on a golden bar. Christian imagery includes the white lily (resurrection). Themes of love, grief and religious faith pervade the poem.

2.4.3.2 Analysis of "The Blessed Damozel"

Theory

Poetry analysis assesses how poet and poem produce effect on the reader. Rossetti blends sensuous imagery with spiritual longing. The reversed perspective — dead woman observing living lover — inverts conventional elegy.

Important Points

- Poetic techniques: symbolism, visual imagery, repetition, medieval/religious diction
- Damozel's perspective from heaven creates dramatic irony — she waits; he grieves below
- Love persists beyond death — central Romantic and religious theme
- White lily, stars, golden bar — layered Christian symbolism
- Tone: melancholic, devotional, longing

- Compare with prose analysis: poetry focuses on sound, rhythm, image and symbol

For Exam

Analysis of Rossetti's poem examines symbolism (white lily, heaven, golden bar), themes of love and grief beyond death, and Pre-Raphaelite visual imagery. The poem's power lies in reversing perspective — the deceased observes the living lover's sorrow.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q5** (1 mark, Aug 2023, May 2024) ★🔥 — What does the 'white lily flower' in "The Blessed Damozel" symbolize? / What does ...
- **Q81** (2 marks, Aug 2023) — What is the difference between poem and poetry?
- **Q91** (2 marks, May 2024) 🔥 — What are the symbols used in the poem 'The Blessed Damozel'?
- **Q104** (2 marks, May 2024) 🔥 — What is the significance of the idea of Love beyond Death in "The Blessed Damozel"?
- **Q148** (5 marks, May 2024) ★🔥 — Discuss the major themes in the poem 'The Blessed Damozel'.
- **Q149** (5 marks, May 2024) — What are the major themes in "The Blessed Damozel"?

Unit Recap (from SLM)

- Literature: Kalam (*Ignited Minds*), Saki (*Open Window*), Rossetti (*Blessed Damozel*)
- Kalam: dream 30 Sept 2001; five thinkers; education + spirituality
- Saki: Vera; window symbol; childhood; chaos vs order
- Rossetti: white lily = resurrection; love, grief, religion

Block 3: Language Development

Unit 1: Parts of Speech

3.1.1 Noun

Theory

A **noun** is a naming word for persons, places, things, ideas or qualities.

Traditional grammar classifies **eight parts of speech**. Nouns may be concrete or abstract, countable or uncountable, and follow rules for gender, number and possession.

Important Points

- **Concrete nouns:** tangible — proper (Gandhi, India), common (man, city), collective (crowd, team, jury), material (gold, soil)
- **Abstract nouns:** intangible — friendship, beauty, poverty, courage, music
- **Countable:** apple, lions, books — use a/an/the; have plural forms
- **Uncountable:** advice, luggage, information, furniture, courage, music — no plural, no a/an
- **Dual usage:** coffee, chocolate, hair, noise — countable or uncountable by meaning
- **Compound nouns:** mother-in-law, toothpaste, Chairperson
- **Possessive nouns:** apostrophe + s (Ravi's book)
- **Gender:** masculine, feminine, common, neuter
- **Plural rules:** regular (-s/-es); irregular (man → men, child → children); same form (sheep, deer, fish)
- Error: "advices" → **advice** (uncountable); "informations" → **information**

For Exam

A noun is a naming word. Concrete nouns (proper, common, collective, material) name tangible things; abstract nouns name ideas and qualities. Countable nouns have plurals; uncountable nouns (advice, furniture, luggage) do not. Collective nouns name groups.

3.1.1.1 Concrete and Abstract Nouns

Theory **Concrete nouns** name things perceived through the senses — persons, places and objects. **Abstract nouns** name ideas, emotions, qualities and states that cannot be touched.

Important Points

- **Proper noun:** specific name — Gandhi, India, Monday, English (capitalised)

- **Common noun:** general name — man, city, book, river
- **Collective noun:** group — crowd, team, jury, flock, committee
- **Material noun:** substance — gold, water, iron, sand
- **Abstract noun:** friendship, beauty, poverty, honesty, knowledge, freedom
- Concrete = tangible; abstract = intangible (feelings, ideas, qualities)
- Music can be abstract (art form) or concrete depending on context

For Exam

Concrete nouns include proper (Gandhi), common (city), collective (team) and material (gold). Abstract nouns name intangible concepts like friendship, beauty and poverty. Collective nouns refer to groups treated as a single entity.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q89** (2 marks, May 2024) — Explain the term Abstract Noun. Give two examples.
- **Q151** (5 marks, May 2024) — Write a note on concrete nouns and abstract nouns.

3.1.1.2 Compound and Possessive Nouns

Theory **Compound nouns** combine two or more words into a single naming unit. **Possessive nouns** show ownership using apostrophe + s.

Important Points

- **Compound nouns:** mother-in-law, toothpaste, blackboard, Chairperson, bus stop
- Written as one word, hyphenated or separate — note-book, notebook
- **Possessive:** apostrophe + s for singular (Ravi's book, the girl's bag)
- Plural possessive: students' projects (plural ending in s → apostrophe after s)
- Irregular plural possessive: children's playground, men's hostel

For Exam

Compound nouns join two or more words (mother-in-law, toothpaste). Possessive nouns show ownership with apostrophe + s (Ravi's book). Plural possessives place apostrophe after s (students' projects).

3.1.1.3 Gender of Nouns

Theory

English nouns may be **masculine**, **feminine**, **common** or **neuter**. Modern English increasingly uses common gender nouns (teacher, doctor) rather than gender-specific forms.

Important Points

- **Masculine:** king, actor, bull, hero, patron, landlord
- **Feminine:** queen, actress, cow, heroine, **patroness**, **landlady**
- **Common gender:** teacher, student, doctor, friend, child
- **Neuter:** book, table, city, idea (non-living or abstract)
- Some nouns have masculine/feminine pairs: man/woman, king/queen, actor/actress
- **PYQ pairs:** Patron → **Patroness**; Landlord → **Landlady**

For Exam

Noun gender in English: masculine (king), feminine (queen), common (teacher, doctor) and neuter (book, table). Common gender nouns apply to any sex.

Exam pairs: Patron → Patroness; Landlord → Landlady.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q25** (1 mark, May 2024) — What is the feminine form of the words – Patron and Landlord?

3.1.1.4 Singular and Plural Nouns

Theory

Singular nouns name one; plural nouns name more than one. Regular plurals add -s or -es; many nouns have irregular plural forms.

Important Points

- **Regular plural:** cat → cats, box → boxes, baby → babies, knife → knives, loaf → **loaves**
- **Irregular plural:** man → men, woman → women, child → children, foot → feet, tooth → teeth, mouse → mice, fungus → **fungi**
- **Same form:** sheep, deer, fish, aircraft (singular = plural)

- **Uncountable nouns:** no plural — advice, furniture, information, luggage, equipment
- Error: two **advices** → two pieces of **advice**; many **furnitures** → much **furniture**
- **PYQ:** Fungus → **Fungi**; Loaf → **Loaves**; Here **are** my lugguages → Here **is** my **luggage**

For Exam

Regular plurals add -s/-es. Irregular forms include man → men, child → children, fungus → fungi, loaf → loaves. Some nouns share singular/plural form (sheep, deer). Uncountable nouns have no plural — luggage (not *luggages*).

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q27** (1 mark, May 2024) — Write the plural form of 'Fungus' and 'Loaf'.
- **Q64** (1 mark, Oct 2025) — Correct the following sentence — Here are my lugguages.

3.1.2 Verb

Theory

A **verb** indicates action, state or occurrence. Verbs are classified as lexical or auxiliary, regular or irregular, transitive or intransitive, stative or dynamic, linking, finite or non-finite.

Important Points

- **Lexical verbs:** independent meaning — run, write, think
- **Auxiliary verbs:** helping verbs — **primary** (am, is, are, was, were, have, has, had, do, does, did) and **modal** (will, shall, can, could, may, might, must, should, ought to)
- **Regular verbs:** past = base + -ed (walk → walked)
- **Irregular verbs:** unique past forms (go → went, write → wrote)
- **Transitive:** takes object — She reads **a book**
- **Intransitive:** no object — Birds **fly**
- **Stative verbs:** states (know, believe, own) — usually not continuous (*I know*, not *I am knowing*)
- **Dynamic verbs:** actions (run, eat) — can be continuous

- **Linking verbs:** connect subject to complement — is, seem, become, look, feel
- **Finite verbs:** show tense and subject agreement
- **Non-finite verbs:** infinitives (to go), participles (going, gone), gerunds (Swimming is fun)
- **Verb pairs:** hanged (executed) vs hung (suspended); deny (not true) vs refuse (decline); agree (same opinion) vs accept (receive willingly)

For Exam

Lexical verbs carry main meaning; auxiliaries help (primary + modal). Transitive verbs need an object; intransitive do not. Linking verbs connect subject to complement. Finite verbs show tense; non-finite forms include infinitives, participles and gerunds. Stative verbs like know and believe avoid continuous forms.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q130** (5 marks, Aug 2023) — What is a verb? Use the pair of words in different sentences. a) resemblance / res...

3.1.2.1 Lexical and Auxiliary Verbs

Theory **Lexical verbs** carry the main meaning of a sentence. **Auxiliary verbs** (helping verbs) support lexical verbs by showing tense, mood or voice.

Important Points

- **Lexical verbs:** run, write, think, play, build — independent meaning
- **Primary auxiliaries:** am, is, are, was, were, have, has, had, do, does, did
- **Modal auxiliaries:** will, shall, can, could, may, might, must, should, ought to
- Auxiliaries cannot stand alone with full meaning — **He is running** (is = auxiliary; running = lexical)
- Modals express ability (can), permission (may), obligation (must), probability (might)

For Exam

Lexical verbs have independent meaning. Auxiliary verbs are helping verbs: primary (am, is, are, have, do) and modal (will, can, must, should). Auxiliaries combine with main verbs to form tenses and express mood.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q7** (1 mark, Aug 2023) — What are lexical verbs?
- **Q36** (1 mark, May 2024) — Use the modal can in a sentence to express ability.
- **Q119** (2 marks, Oct 2025) — The modal 'should' is used to express duty or obligation. Give two examples for th...

3.1.2.2 Regular and Irregular Verbs

Theory **Regular verbs** form past tense and past participle by adding -ed. **Irregular verbs** have unique past forms that must be memorised.

Important Points

- **Regular:** walk → walked → walked; play → played → played; clean → cleaned → cleaned
- **Irregular:** go → went → gone; write → wrote → written; break → broke → broken; see → saw → seen
- Past participle used in perfect tenses: has **gone**, had **written**
- Common irregular: begin, drink, eat, fall, give, know, rise, speak, take, tear

For Exam

Regular verbs add -ed for past and past participle. Irregular verbs have unique forms (go → went → gone). Past participles appear in perfect tenses with has/have/had.

3.1.2.3 Transitive and Intransitive Verbs

Theory

A **transitive verb** requires a direct object to complete its meaning. An **intransitive verb** does not take an object.

Important Points

- **Transitive:** She reads **a book**. / He wrote **a letter**. / They elected **a leader**.
- **Intransitive:** Birds **fly**. / The sun **rises**. / She **slept** well.
- Some verbs are both: **eat** (transitive: eat food; intransitive: eat slowly)
- Passive voice possible only with transitive verbs — A letter **was written**

For Exam

Transitive verbs take a direct object (She reads a book). Intransitive verbs need no object (Birds fly). Only transitive verbs can form passive voice.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q160** (5 marks, May 2024) — Explain transitive and intransitive verbs with detailed examples.

3.1.2.4 Stative and Dynamic Verbs

Theory **Stative verbs** describe states rather than actions and usually avoid continuous forms. **Dynamic verbs** describe actions and processes that can use continuous tenses.

Important Points

- **Stative — senses:** see, hear, smell, taste (I **see** the bird, not *I am seeing*)
- **Stative — thinking:** know, believe, understand, remember, forget, think (= believe)
- **Stative — feeling:** want, like, love, hate, prefer, need
- **Stative — possession:** have, own, belong, possess
- **Stative — appearing:** seem, appear, look (= seem), sound, feel (= seem)
- **Dynamic:** run, eat, write, play, talk, work — can use continuous: She **is running**
- Exception: **feel** can be dynamic — I **am feeling** energetic today (temporary state)

For Exam

Stative verbs (know, believe, want, own, seem) describe states and avoid continuous forms. Dynamic verbs (run, eat, write) describe actions and use continuous tenses. Error: *I am knowing* → I **know**.

3.1.2.5 Linking Verbs

Theory **Linking verbs** connect the subject to a complement (noun or adjective) that describes or identifies it. They do not show action but a state of being.

Important Points

- **Common linking verbs:** is, am, are, was, were, become, seem, appear, look, feel, sound, taste, remain, grow
- Subject + linking verb + complement: She **is** a doctor. / The food **tastes** good. / He **became** president.
- Complement can be noun (She is a **teacher**) or adjective (The sky is **blue**)
- Linking verbs differ from auxiliary **be** in continuous tenses — here **is** links, not helps

For Exam

Linking verbs (is, seem, become, look, feel) connect subject to complement describing or identifying it. Example: She is a doctor; The soup tastes delicious. They show state of being, not action.

3.1.2.6 Finite and Non-finite Verbs

Theory **Finite verbs** show tense and agree with the subject. **Non-finite verbs** (infinitives, participles, gerunds) do not show tense or subject agreement.

Important Points

- **Finite:** She **goes** to school. / They **went** home. / He **will come**.
- **Infinitive:** to go, to eat, to write — I want **to learn** English
- **Participle:** present (going, eating); past (gone, eaten, written) — **Running** fast, he fell
- **Gerund:** verb + -ing as noun — **Swimming** is fun. / I enjoy **reading**.
- Non-finite verbs cannot be main verb of independent clause without auxiliary

For Exam

Finite verbs show tense and subject agreement (She goes). Non-finite forms: infinitives (to go), participles (going, gone) and gerunds (Swimming is fun). Gerunds function as nouns.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q20** (1 mark, May 2024) 🔥 — Write two examples for Gerunds.
- **Q120** (2 marks, Oct 2025) — Give two examples of a gerund being used as the subject of a sentence.

3.1.3 Adjectives and Articles

Theory

An **adjective** modifies a noun, adding description or limitation.

Determiners/Articles (a, an, the, this, that, some, any) limit or specify nouns.

Adjectives appear attributively (before noun) or predicatively (after linking verb).

Important Points

- **Kinds:** descriptive, demonstrative, possessive, interrogative, numeral
- **Attributive:** before noun — red car
- **Predicative:** after linking verb — car is red
- **Degrees of comparison:** positive (tall), comparative (taller/more beautiful), superlative (tallest/most beautiful)
- **Irregular degrees:** good → better → best; bad → worse → worst; far → farther/further → farthest/furthest
- **Special adjectives:** elder/eldest (family); farther/further; later/latter; each/every
- Error: "more taller" → **taller** (double comparative wrong)
- **Indefinite articles — a/an:** *a* before consonant **sound** (a university, a one-rupee coin, a European); *an* before vowel **sound** (an hour, an umbrella, an actor, an honest girl)
- **Definite article — the:** specific noun (the tallest boy); unique things (the sun); superlatives (the best)
- **Zero article:** no article before uncountable/general plurals — advice, furniture; Poland is a European country
- Fill-in: He is **an** actor; **a** one-rupee coin; **the** tallest boy; I need **advice** (no article)

For Exam

Adjectives modify nouns in attributive or predicative position with degrees of comparison (positive, comparative, superlative). Articles: *a* before consonant sound, *an* before vowel sound, *the* for specific/unique/superlative reference, zero article for uncountable nouns and general plurals.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q166** (5 marks, Apr 2025) — Explain the role and function of adjectives in English grammar. Discuss different ...

3.1.3.1 Kinds and Position of Adjectives

Theory

Adjectives are classified by function and may appear before the noun (**attributive**) or after a linking verb (**predicative**).

Important Points

- **Descriptive:** quality — tall, beautiful, intelligent, red
- **Demonstrative:** this, that, these, those — **this** book
- **Possessive:** my, your, his, her, its, our, their
- **Interrogative:** which, what — **Which** colour do you prefer?
- **Numeral:** one, two, first, second, dozen
- **Attributive:** before noun — a **red** car, an **interesting** story
- **Predicative:** after linking verb — The car is **red**. / She looks **tired**.

For Exam

Adjective kinds: descriptive, demonstrative, possessive, interrogative, numeral. Attributive adjectives precede nouns (red car); predicative adjectives follow linking verbs (car is red).

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q152** (5 marks, May 2024, Apr 2025) ★ — What are the different types of adjectives? Give examples.

3.1.3.2 Degrees of Comparison

Theory

Adjectives change form to compare — **positive** (base), **comparative** (two items) and **superlative** (more than two). Short adjectives use -er/-est; longer adjectives use more/most.

Important Points

- **Positive:** tall, beautiful, good, bad, far
- **Comparative:** taller, more beautiful, better, worse, farther/further

- **Superlative:** tallest, most beautiful, best, worst, farthest/furthest
- **Rules:** one syllable → -er/-est (tall → taller → tallest); two+ syllables → more/most (beautiful → more beautiful → most beautiful)
- **Irregular:** good → better → best; bad → worse → worst; little → less → least; much/many → more → most
- **Special pairs:** elder/eldest (family members); farther (distance) vs further (additional)
- **Later vs Latter (Q134):**
 - **Later** = at a subsequent time — *See you later.*
 - **Latter** = the second of two things mentioned — *Tea and coffee were offered; I chose the latter.* (coffee)
- Error: **more taller** → **taller**; **most best** → **best**
- Construction: India is **the largest** democracy; She is **smarter than** her brother

For Exam

Degrees of comparison: positive (tall), comparative (taller/more beautiful), superlative (tallest/most beautiful). Irregular: good → better → best. Avoid double comparatives (more taller). Elder/eldest used for family members. **Later** = subsequent time; **Latter** = second of two mentioned.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q13** (1 mark, Aug 2023) — Tharu is — than Pathu (tallest/tall/taller).
- **Q23** (1 mark, May 2024) — Write a sentence in Comparative degree.
- **Q101** (2 marks, May 2024) — Convert to comparative and superlative forms: Very few countries in the world are ...
- **Q134** (5 marks, Aug 2023) — What is the difference between later and latter? Give examples.

3.1.3.3 Determiners and Articles

Theory **Determiners** limit or specify nouns. **Articles** (a, an, the) are the most common determiners. Other determiners include this, that, some, any, many, few, each, every.

Important Points

- **a:** consonant sound — a university, a European, a one-rupee coin, a union minister
- **an:** vowel sound — an hour, an umbrella, an actor, an honest girl, an egg, an electric fence
- **the:** specific/unique — the sun, the tallest boy, the Ganges, the President
- **Zero article:** uncountables (advice, furniture); general plurals; most proper names (Poland is a European country)
- Fill-in (SLM): He is **an** actor; **a** one-rupee coin; **the** tallest boy; **an** umbrella; **a** pair of shoes
- **Some/any:** some (affirmative/offers); any (negative/questions) — I have **some** books. / Do you have **any** money?
- **Little / a little / few / a few (Q154):**

Expression	Meaning	Example
little	almost none (negative)	little money = hardly any
a little	some, small amount (positive)	a little money = some
few	almost none, not many (negative)	few friends
a few	some, small number (positive)	a few friends

- **Little** in "He has little money" = almost none / hardly any (negative sense)
- **The few** books he had were spoiled (specific small number he possessed)

For Exam

Articles: *a* before consonant sound, *an* before vowel sound, *the* for specific/unique reference. Zero article before uncountable nouns and general statements. Determiners include this, that, some, any, many, few. **Little/few** = almost none (negative); **a little/a few** = some (positive).

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q12** (1 mark, Aug 2023) — — books he had in his library were spoiled (few/ the few).
- **Q37** (1 mark, May 2024) — He has little money in his purse. What does little mean in this sentence?
- **Q43** (1 mark, May 2024) — Put a, an or the in the sentence: — honest man is — noblest work of God.

- **Q154** (5 marks, May 2024) — Differentiate between little and a little; few and a few.
- **Q177** (5 marks, Oct 2025) — What are determiners? List the different types and give examples.

3.1.4 Adverb

Theory

An **adverb** modifies a verb, adjective or another adverb, indicating manner, time, place, frequency or degree. Position varies; typical order is manner → place → time.

Important Points

- **Kinds:** time (now, yesterday), place (here, home), manner (quickly, well), frequency (always, often), degree (very, too)
- **Position:** varies — front, mid or end of sentence
- **Order of adverbs:** manner → place → time — “She spoke softly at home yesterday”
- Example: “She **quickly** ran **home**” — quickly = manner adverb; home = place adverb
- Adverbs modify verbs, adjectives and other adverbs

For Exam

An adverb modifies verbs, adjectives or other adverbs, showing manner, time, place, frequency or degree. Order of multiple adverbs: manner, place, time.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q4** (1 mark, Aug 2023) — The examination was —— difficult. (fairly/rather)
- **Q6** (1 mark, Aug 2023) — Pick the adverb of manner in the following sentence. Sarita walked gracefully.
- **Q19** (1 mark, May 2024) — Give two examples of Adverbs of manners.

3.1.4.2 Position and Order of Adverbs

Theory

Adverb position varies by type. When multiple adverbs appear, the typical order is **manner** → **place** → **time**.

Important Points

- **Manner adverbs:** often after verb or object — She spoke **softly**; He runs **quickly**
- **Place adverbs:** after verb — She waited **outside**; They live **here**
- **Time adverbs:** often end of sentence — I **yesterday** met him / I met him **yesterday**
- **Frequency:** before main verb — He **always** comes; after **be** — She is **often** late
- **Order:** manner → place → time — “She spoke softly at home yesterday”
- **Degree adverbs** (very, too, quite) before adjectives — **very** beautiful
- Adverbs modify verbs, adjectives and other adverbs (exam answer)

For Exam

Adverb position varies by type. Order of multiple adverbs: manner, place, time. Frequency adverbs (always, often) precede main verb. Degree adverbs (very, quite) precede adjectives.

3.1.5 Pronoun

Theory

A **pronoun** replaces a noun to avoid repetition. Types include personal, possessive, demonstrative, relative, reciprocal, interrogative, reflexive and indefinite.

Important Points

- **Personal:** I, he, she, they, we, you, it
- **Possessive:** mine, his, hers, theirs, ours
- **Demonstrative:** this, that, these, those — point to specific things
- **Relative:** who, which, that — refer back to nouns
- **Reciprocal:** each other, one another
- **Interrogative:** who, what, which
- **Reflexive:** myself, yourself, themselves
- **Indefinite:** someone, anybody, everyone, none

For Exam

Pronouns replace nouns. Types: personal, possessive, demonstrative (point to specific things), relative (refer back to nouns), reciprocal, interrogative, reflexive and indefinite.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q45** (1 mark, Apr 2025) — Replace the italicized noun with appropriate pronoun: John and Mary went to the ma...

3.1.5.1 Pronoun Types — Reference

Theory

Each pronoun type serves a distinct grammatical function. Recognising types helps in sentence analysis and error correction in exams.

Important Points

Type	Function	Examples
Personal	Replace noun as subject/object	I, he, she, they, we, you, it
Possessive	Show ownership	mine, his, hers, theirs, ours, yours
Demonstrative	Point to specific person/thing	this, that, these, those
Relative	Connect clause to antecedent noun	who, which, that, whom, whose
Reciprocal	Express mutual action	each other, one another
Interrogative	Ask questions	who, what, which, whom
Reflexive	Refer back to subject	myself, yourself, themselves
Indefinite	Non-specific reference	someone, anybody, everyone, none, all

- Demonstrative pronouns **point to specific** persons or things (exam answer)
- Personal pronouns **depict persons in many forms** — I, he, she, they (exam answer)
- Relative pronouns refer back to a noun mentioned earlier — **The book that I read**

For Exam

Eight pronoun types: personal (I, he, they), possessive (mine, his), demonstrative (this, that — point to specific things), relative (who, which —

refer back to nouns), reciprocal (each other), interrogative (who, what), reflexive (myself) and indefinite (someone, anybody).

3.1.6 Preposition

Theory

A **preposition** shows the relation of a noun or pronoun to other words in the sentence. Types include simple, compound and phrase prepositions.

Important Points

- **Simple:** in, on, at, by, for, with, from, to
- **Compound:** into, upon, within, without
- **Phrase prepositions:** along with, because of, in spite of, according to
- Example: "The book **on** the table **is** mine" — on = preposition
- Common errors: take **to** nation-building (not "to" duplicated incorrectly)

For Exam

Prepositions show relationship between nouns/pronouns and other words. Simple (in, on, at), compound (into, upon) and phrase prepositions (along with, because of) function as single units connecting sentence elements.

3.1.6.2 Use of Prepositions

Theory

Prepositions indicate relationships of time, place, direction, manner and association. Correct preposition choice is essential for idiomatic English.

Important Points

- **Time:** at (3 o'clock), on (Monday), in (January, 2025); in the morning; at night
- **Place:** at (point — at the door), on (surface — on the table), in (enclosed — in the room)
- **Direction:** to, into, from, towards, through — walk **to** school; go **into** the building
- **Manner/Association:** by (by bus), with (with friends), about (about politics)
- **Common phrases:** depend **on**; interested **in**; good **at**; afraid **of**; listen **to**

- Phrase prepositions: **according to, in spite of, because of, along with**
- Error: take it **to** nation-building (correct collocation)

For Exam

Prepositions show time (at/on/in), place (at/on/in), direction (to/into/from) and association relationships. Phrase prepositions (according to, because of) function as single units. Common collocations: depend on, interested in, good at.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q80** (2 marks, Aug 2023) — a) Kamala gifted me a bangle made — silver. (from/of) b) Paper is made — tre...
- **Q169** (5 marks, Apr 2025) — Fill in the blanks with appropriate prepositions from the list — The bicycle glide...

3.1.7 Conjunction

Theory

A **conjunction** joins words, phrases or clauses. Coordinating conjunctions connect equal elements; subordinating conjunctions introduce dependent clauses; correlative conjunctions work in pairs.

Important Points

- **Coordinating:** and, but, or, nor, for, yet, so — join equal parts
- **Subordinating:** because, although, if, when, while, unless — introduce subordinate clauses
- **Correlative:** either...or, neither...nor, not only...but also, both...and
- Compound sentence uses coordinating conjunction: Birds fly **and** fish swim

For Exam

Conjunctions join sentence elements. Coordinating (and, but, or) connect equal parts; subordinating (because, although, if) introduce dependent clauses; correlative (either...or, neither...nor) work in pairs.

3.1.7.1 Types of Conjunctions — Reference

Theory

Conjunctions are essential for building compound and complex sentences.

Each type connects different sentence elements and creates distinct logical relationships.

Important Points

Type	Function	Examples	Sentence Example
Coordinating	Join equal words, phrases or clauses	and, but, or, nor, for, yet, so	Birds fly and fish swim.
Subordinating	Introduce dependent clause	because, although, if, when, while, unless	Birds fly when spring arrives.
Correlative	Work in pairs	either...or, neither...nor, not only...but also, both...and	Either tea or coffee is fine.

- Coordinating conjunctions create **compound sentences** (two main clauses)
- Subordinating conjunctions create **complex sentences** (main + subordinate)
- **FANBOYS** mnemonic for coordinating: For, And, Nor, But, Or, Yet, So
- Correlative conjunctions must use **parallel structure** — Either you stay **or** you leave

For Exam

Three conjunction types: coordinating (and, but, or — join equal elements), subordinating (because, although, if — introduce dependent clauses) and correlative (either...or, neither...nor — paired conjunctions). Compound sentences use coordinating; complex sentences use subordinating conjunctions.

3.1.8 Interjection

Theory

An **interjection** expresses sudden emotion or feeling, standing apart from the grammatical structure. It is followed by an exclamation mark.

Important Points

- **Happiness:** Hurrah!, Yippee!, Bravo!
- **Sorrow:** Alas!, Oh dear!
- **Surprise:** Oh!, Wow!, What!

- Example: "**Wow!** What a surprise!" — Wow = interjection
- Eight parts of speech total: noun, verb, adjective, adverb, pronoun, preposition, conjunction, interjection

For Exam

An interjection expresses sudden emotion (Hurrah!, Alas!, Wow!) and is set off from the sentence. Together with the other seven parts of speech, it completes the traditional grammatical classification.

3.1.8.1 Types of Interjections

Theory

Interjections express sudden feelings and are common in exclamatory sentences. They stand apart from the grammatical structure of the sentence and are followed by an exclamation mark.

Important Points

Emotion	Interjections	Example Sentence
Happiness/Joy	Hurrah!, Yippee!, Bravo!, Cheers!	Hurrah! We won the match.
Sorrow/Pain	Alas!, Oh dear!, Ouch!	Alas! The hero died.
Surprise	Oh!, Wow!, What!, Ah!	Wow! What a surprise!
Approval	Bravo!, Well done!, Hear, hear!	Bravo! Excellent performance.
Disgust/Disapproval	Ugh!, Yuck!, Boo!	Ugh! That smells terrible.

- Interjection for **happiness** in exam: **Hurrah!** or **Yippee!**
- "**Wow!** What a surprise!" — Wow is the interjection
- Interjections are followed by ! (exclamation mark)
- Eight parts of speech: noun, verb, adjective, adverb, pronoun, preposition, conjunction, interjection

For Exam

Interjections express sudden emotions: Hurrah!/Yippee! (happiness), Alas! (sorrow), Wow!/Oh! (surprise). They are set off from the sentence with exclamation marks. English has eight parts of speech; interjection is the eighth.

Unit Recap (from SLM)

- Eight parts of speech; nouns countable/uncountable; verb types and auxiliaries
- Articles: a/an/the/zero; adjective degrees of comparison
- Pronoun types; prepositions simple/compound/phrase; conjunction types

Unit 2: Sentences

3.2.1 Sentence and Its Parts

Theory

A **sentence** is a group of words expressing a complete thought — not merely any word group. It has a **subject** (naming part) and **predicate** (telling part).

Purpose of language is communication through statements, questions, requests and exclamations.

Important Points

- **Subject:** who or what the sentence is about — Ram, The committee, Nobody
- **Predicate:** tells something about the subject — is riding a bicycle, has voted
- Example: "Ram is riding a bicycle" — Subject: Ram; Predicate: is riding a bicycle
- Correct sentence: **Gandhiji is regarded as the Father of our Nation.**
- Rearrange: he singer talented is a → **He is a talented singer.**
- Complete thought distinguishes sentence from phrase or fragment

For Exam

A sentence expresses a complete thought with subject (naming part) and predicate (telling part). Example: "Ram is riding a bicycle" — subject Ram, predicate is riding a bicycle.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q30** (1 mark, May 2024) — Identify the Subject and Predicate in the sentence: The naughty cat is playing wit...
- **Q42** (1 mark, May 2024) — Pick out the subject and predicate in the sentence: My younger brother serves in t...

- **Q46** (1 mark, Apr 2025) — Identify the subject and predicate in the following sentence: The quick brown fox ...

3.2.2 Types of Sentences by Purpose

Theory

Sentences are classified by purpose into assertive, interrogative, imperative and exclamatory. Each type uses distinct punctuation and structure.

Important Points

- **Assertive/Declarative:** states fact — ends with full stop (.) — The sun sets in the west.
- **Interrogative:** asks question — ends with ? — Yes/No type; Wh- type (who, what, where, when, why, how)
- **Imperative:** command, request or wish — Get out. / Please sit down. / Let us go.
- **Exclamatory:** sudden feeling — ends with ! — What a huge building! / What a clever boy!
- Identify: "Where are you going?" → Interrogative; "Please sit down." → Imperative (request)

For Exam

Four sentence types: assertive (states fact), interrogative (asks question — Yes/No or Wh-), imperative (command/request) and exclamatory (sudden emotion). Imperative sentences express commands, wishes or requests.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q26** (1 mark, May 2024) — Mention three Wh question words.
- **Q68** (1 mark, Oct 2025) — Identify the type of question: What is the capital city of France?
- **Q109** (2 marks, Apr 2025) — What are the main types of sentences in English?
- **Q139** (5 marks, May 2024, Apr 2025) ★ — What are the different types of sentences?

3.2.3 Question Tags

Theory

A **question tag** is a short question added to a statement for confirmation. Tags follow specific polarity and auxiliary rules.

Important Points

- Positive statement → **negative tag**: She is a doctor, **isn't she?**
- Negative statement → **positive tag**: They won't come, **will they?**
- Semi-negatives (hardly, scarcely, rarely, barely) → **positive tag**: He hardly knows her, **does he?**
- **Imperative** → **will you?** Open the door, **will you?**
- **Let us** → **shall we?** Let us go, **shall we?**
- **I am** → **aren't I?** I am late, **aren't I?**
- Negative words (nobody, nothing, never) → positive tag: Nobody called, **did they?**
- Modal verbs: She can swim, **can't she?**
- Model paper: You have a sister, **don't you?** He is very happy today, **isn't he?**

For Exam

Question tags confirm statements. Positive statement takes negative tag; negative statement takes positive tag. Semi-negatives (hardly, scarcely) take positive tags. Imperatives use "will you?"; "Let us" uses "shall we?"; "I am" uses "aren't I?".

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q38** (1 mark, May 2024) — He is a pilot. Supply an appropriate question tag to this sentence.
- **Q65** (1 mark, Oct 2025) — Provide a question tag for the following sentence: Let us go for a movie.
- **Q79** (2 marks, Aug 2023) — Use the correct question tags. a) Megha studies well ---? b) The evening is beaut...

3.2.4 Sentence Structure and Transformation

Theory

By structure, sentences are **simple** (one main clause), **compound** (two+ main

clauses) or **complex** (main + subordinate clauses). **Transformation** converts one type to another — statements to questions, assertive to exclamatory, etc.

Important Points

- **Simple:** one main clause — Birds fly.
- **Compound:** two+ main clauses joined by coordinating conjunction — Birds fly **and** fish swim.
- **Complex:** one main + subordinate clause(s) — Birds fly **when** spring arrives.
- **Positive:** affirmative without negative words
- **Negative:** contains not, never, hardly, scarcely — Hurry up! We have hardly one hour left.
- Assertive → Interrogative: She is a student. → **Is she a student?**
- Assertive → Exclamatory: It is a beautiful day. → **What a beautiful day it is!**
- Imperative → Interrogative: Close the window. → **Will you close the window?**
- Assertive → Imperative (model): Open the doors → **You should open the doors and windows.**
- **Reported speech basics:** Direct: He said, "I **am** tired." → Indirect: He said that he **was** tired.
- Reported speech rules: present → past; will → would; questions become statement order
- Direct: Alex, "My sister hasn't eaten dragon fruit before." → Alex said her sister **hadn't eaten** dragon fruit before.
- **Active/Passive basics:** Active: The teacher **teaches** the lesson. → Passive: The lesson **is taught** by the teacher.
- Active: She **wrote** a letter. → Passive: A letter **was written** by her. Rule: object of active → subject of passive; be + past participle

For Exam

Simple sentence = one main clause; compound = two or more main clauses; complex = main + subordinate. Sentence transformation converts between types. Reported speech shifts tenses (present → past). Active voice emphasises doer; passive emphasises action/object using be + past participle.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q11** (1 mark, Aug 2023) — The Principal will announce the results. (Change the voice)
- **Q48** (1 mark, Apr 2025) — Convert the following active sentence to passive voice: The chef cooks the meal.
- **Q53** (1 mark, Apr 2025) — Rewrite the following sentence using reported speech: "She said, 'I am going to th..."
- **Q83** (2 marks, Aug 2023) — What is meant by "voice"? Which voice is used to emphasize an action?
- **Q167** (5 marks, Apr 2025) — Rewrite the following sentences from passive voice into active voice: a) The lette...
- **Q168** (5 marks, Apr 2025) — Explain the difference between complex and compound sentences. Provide examples of...
- **Q184** (5 marks, Oct 2025) — Rewrite the direct speech as reported speech to complete the sentences: a) 'We've ...
- **Q193** (10 marks, —) — Identify whether the following sentences are simple, compound or complex sentences...

3.2.4.1 Statements to Questions

Theory

Converting **assertive to interrogative** sentences uses inversion of subject and auxiliary, or addition of do/does/did for simple present/past.

Important Points

- She is a student. → **Is she a student?**
- He is a professor. → **Is he a professor?** (model paper)
- They play cricket. → **Do they play cricket?**
- She went home. → **Did she go home?**
- Inversion: auxiliary before subject for be/have/modals

For Exam

Assertive to interrogative: invert subject and auxiliary (Is she a student?) or use do/does/did (Do they play cricket?). Wh- questions replace subject or add wh-word.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q8** (1 mark, Aug 2023) — He is a doctor. (Change into question)

3.2.4.2 Other Sentence Transformations

Theory

Sentences transform between assertive, exclamatory, imperative and interrogative forms while preserving core meaning.

Important Points

- Assertive → Exclamatory: It is a beautiful day. → **What a beautiful day it is!**
- Imperative → Interrogative: Close the window. → **Will you close the window?**
- Assertive → Imperative: Open the doors → **You should open the doors and windows.**
- Exclamatory → Assertive: What a clever boy! → **He is a very clever boy.** / What a delicious pudding! → **It is a very delicious pudding.**
- Imperative → Interrogative (request): Please help me. → **Will you please help me?**
- Negative ↔ Positive: He is not honest. ↔ He is dishonest. / My dog loves... → My dog **does not love...**
- **too...to / enough...to (Q73)**: He was **too nervous to** perform well. / He was not confident **enough to** perform well.
- Compound → Simple: Anooja is busy and she cannot attend you now. → Anooja is **too busy to** attend you now. / Being busy, Anooja cannot attend you now.
- Complex → Compound: This is the shop which sells fruits and vegetables. → This is the shop. It sells fruits and vegetables.
- Simple → Complex: Because of the rain, we stayed home. → **Because** it rained, we decided to stay back home.

For Exam

Sentence transformations: assertive ↔ interrogative (inversion/do-forms), assertive → exclamatory (What a...!), exclamatory → assertive (It is a very...).

Too...to = excess prevents action; **enough...to** = sufficient for action. Preserve meaning while changing form and punctuation.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q9** (1 mark, Aug 2023) — Change the compound sentence into a simple sentence. Anooja is busy and she cannot...
- **Q22** (1 mark, May 2024) — Transform a Positive sentence into a Negative sentence: My dog loves to walk in th...
- **Q24** (1 mark, May 2024) — Change the Question into a Statement: Why don't you study well?
- **Q73** (1 mark, Oct 2025) — Rewrite the following sentence using too...to or enough...to — He was very nervous. He...
- **Q82** (2 marks, Aug 2023) — Transform the following complex sentence to compound sentence. This is the shop wh...
- **Q136** (5 marks, Aug 2023) — What is an assertive sentence? Change the following sentences into assertive. a) W...
- **Q153** (5 marks, May 2024) — Change exclamatory sentences to assertive: a) "What a beautiful sunset!" b) "How d...
- **Q202** (10 marks, —) — Go through the following simple sentences and transform them into complex sentence...

Unit Recap (from SLM)

- Four sentence types; simple, compound, complex structure
- Question tag rules; sentence transformation
- Reported speech and active/passive basics

Unit 3: Concord

3.3.1 Subject-Verb Agreement (Concord)

Theory **Concord** means agreement; in grammar it is **subject-verb agreement** — subject and verb must agree in person and number. Three types: grammatical, notional and proximity.

Important Points

- **Grammatical concord — Person:** I → am/was (conditional: I wish I **were**); he/she/it → is/was; they/we → are/were
- **Grammatical concord — Number:** singular subject → singular verb; plural subject → plural verb
- **Notional concord:** meaning-based — collective as unit → singular (The council **has**); as individuals → plural (The jury **were** divided)
- **Concord of proximity:** verb agrees with nearest noun — either...or / neither...nor → nearer subject
- **And** connecting subjects → plural (Meenu and Ajayan **are** doctors) unless single idea (Bread and butter **is** my breakfast)
- **There** sentences: verb agrees with subject after *there* — There **are** twelve mangoes
- **Police, cattle, people** → plural verb
- **A pair of spectacles** → singular verb (**is**, not are)
- **One of/each of/every one of** → plural noun + singular verb — Each of the members **has** voted
- **A number of** → plural (A number of people **are** waiting); **The number of** → singular (The number of artists **is** ten)
- **Each/every/either/neither/somebody/nobody** → singular verb
- **Mathematics, Politics, Physics, news** → singular verb — The news **is** good
- **Many a / More than one** → singular noun + singular verb — Many a student **was** absent
- **Subjects of measurement:** Rs. 100 **is** enough; 250 km **is**; Two-thirds of the water **is** dirty
- **Titles of books:** *Sons and Lovers* **is** a novel by D.H. Lawrence
- **Mary along with her son goes** to church (first subject singular); **Neither Sarath nor his friends have** won (nearer plural)
- **A bunch of keys is** missing (collective as unit); **The committee meets** every week

For Exam

Concord = subject-verb agreement (grammatical, notional, proximity). And → plural unless single idea (bread and butter **is**). Either...or/neither...nor → verb

with nearer subject. Police/cattle/people → plural. A pair of spectacles **is**. A number of **are**; The number of **is**. Mathematics/news **is**. Each/every/somebody → singular.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q15** (1 mark, Aug 2023) — A pair of spectacles — on the table. (are/is)
- **Q39** (1 mark, May 2024) — Name the concord which states that the verb should agree with the nearby noun.
- **Q47** (1 mark, Apr 2025) — Choose the correct verb to complete the sentence: Neither the teacher nor the stud...
- **Q133** (5 marks, Aug 2023) — What is concord? What are the three different types of concord?
- **Q178** (5 marks, Oct 2025) — Explain grammatical concord with examples.
- **Q183** (5 marks, Oct 2025) — Supply a verb in the following sentences in agreement with the subject: a) Ninety ...

3.3.2 Common Concord Errors

Theory

Error spotting in concord tests understanding of collective nouns, quantifiers and -s nouns that are grammatically singular.

Important Points

-  The news **are** good. →  The news **is** good.
-  Each of the members **have** voted. →  Each of the members **has** voted.
-  A number of people **is** waiting. →  A number of people **are** waiting.
-  The committee **are** unanimous. →  The committee **is** unanimous. (acting as unit)
-  Two-thirds of the water **are** dirty. →  Two-thirds of the water **is** dirty.
-  Many a student **were** absent. →  Many a student **was** absent.
-  There **is** many books. →  There **are** many books.
-  **Each** of the girls **are** ready. →  **is** ready.

- Fill-in (SLM): Somebody **has** taken my bottle; A good number of artists **are** coming

For Exam

Common concord errors involve news (singular), each/every (singular verb), a number of (plural) vs the number of (singular), collective nouns acting as unit (singular) and fraction/subject of measurement (verb agrees with noun after of).

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q67** (1 mark, Oct 2025) — Correct the concord error in the sentence: The people who lives next door asked me...

Unit Recap (from SLM)

- Concord: grammatical, notional, proximity
- Key rules: and, either...or, collective nouns, a number of vs the number of
- Mathematics, news, police, cattle — special agreement patterns

Unit 4: Tenses

3.4.1 Tenses — Overview

Theory **Tense** denotes time of action — present, past or future. Each tense has four forms: Simple, Continuous, Perfect and Perfect Continuous, giving **12 forms** total. Choosing the correct tense depends on whether the action is habitual, ongoing, completed or connected across time.

Important Points

- Three tenses × four forms = **12 tense forms**
- **Simple Present:** habitual action, universal truth, permanent state, scheduled future, instructions — time words: always, usually, often, every day
- **Present Continuous:** action now, temporary situations, definite future plan — is/am/are + verb-ing
- **Present Perfect:** has/have + past participle — recent action (no time stated), continuing from past (since/for), completed with present result

- **Present Perfect Continuous:** has/have been + verb-ing — action started in past continuing to now with duration
- **Simple Past:** completed action at definite past time — regular -ed / irregular forms
- **Past Continuous:** was/were + verb-ing — ongoing past action, background action
- **Past Perfect:** had + past participle — action completed before another past action
- **Past Perfect Continuous:** had been + verb-ing — continuous action before past point
- **Simple Future:** will/shall + base verb — prediction, future event
- **Future Continuous:** will be + verb-ing — ongoing future action
- **Future Perfect:** will have + past participle — completed before future point
- **Future Perfect Continuous:** will have been + verb-ing — duration up to future point

For Exam

Tense denotes time of action. Twelve forms arise from three tenses (present, past, future) each with simple, continuous, perfect and perfect continuous forms. Universal truths use Simple Present; actions happening now use Present Continuous; recent unspecified past uses Present Perfect.

3.4.2 Present Tenses

Theory

The four present tense forms describe current, habitual, ongoing and completed-present actions.

Important Points

- **Simple Present:** base/s + es — habit, universal truth, permanent state — He **goes** to temple daily; Earth **revolves** around sun
- **Present Continuous:** am/is/are + ing — action now, temporary — She **is reading** now; I **am feeling** energetic (dynamic feel)
- **Present Perfect:** has/have + past participle — recent/no time stated — I **have finished** homework; **have not seen** cousin lately

- **Present Perfect Continuous:** has/have been + ing — duration from past to now — Her son **has been living** there for five years
- ❌ She **is going** daily → ✅ She **goes** daily (habit); ❌ He **has reading** → ✅ He **is reading**
- Since/for with perfect: I **have lived** here **since** 2010 / **for** ten years

For Exam

Present tenses: Simple (habit/truth), Continuous (now), Perfect (recent/unspecified), Perfect Continuous (duration to now). Universal truth → Simple Present. Action now → Present Continuous. Since/for used with perfect tenses.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q110** (2 marks, Apr 2025) — What is the present continuous tense used for?

3.4.3 Past Tenses

Theory

The four past tense forms describe completed, ongoing, prior-completed and continuous-past actions.

Important Points

- **Simple Past:** regular -ed / irregular — definite past time — Vinay **went** to London last year; I **met** her yesterday
- **Past Continuous:** was/were + ing — ongoing past, background — They **were playing** when it rained; When I came in, you **were talking**
- **Past Perfect:** had + past participle — action before another past — He **had left** before I arrived; Bus **had left** when he reached station
- **Past Perfect Continuous:** had been + ing — duration before past point — She **had been working** for two hours before break
- ❌ When I reached, he **already left** → ✅ he **had already left** (Past Perfect)
- Past Continuous sets scene; Simple Past states main event

For Exam

Past tenses: Simple (definite past), Continuous (ongoing past), Perfect (earlier

past action), Perfect Continuous (past duration). Past Perfect (had + past participle) shows action completed before another past action.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q14** (1 mark, Aug 2023) — He had write a play. (Correct the sentence)
- **Q28** (1 mark, May 2024) — Use the right form of the verb: My brother _____ to Mumbai last month.
- **Q44** (1 mark, May 2024) — Use the correct form of the verb: When he — (arrive) the train — (leave).
- **Q58** (1 mark, Apr 2025) — Change the sentence "She sings beautifully" into the past tense.
- **Q132** (5 marks, Aug 2023) — What are the uses of Past Continuous Tense.

3.4.4 Future Tenses

Theory

The four future tense forms describe predictions, ongoing future, completed-future and future duration actions.

Important Points

- **Simple Future:** will/shall + base — prediction — They **will discuss** soon; We **will win** this game
- **Future Continuous:** will be + ing — ongoing future — President **will be addressing** crowd this evening
- **Future Perfect:** will have + past participle — completed before future point — By next year, she **will have completed** degree
- **Future Perfect Continuous:** will have been + ing — duration to future point — By 2022, Leena **will have been living** in Delhi for twenty years
- By + future time → Future Perfect — By tomorrow evening, I **will have discussed** the matter
- Will vs shall: will (general future); shall (formal/intention with I/we)

For Exam

Future tenses: Simple (will + base), Continuous (will be + ing), Perfect (will have + past participle), Perfect Continuous (will have been + ing). By + future deadline → Future Perfect. Future Continuous for ongoing future action.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q66** (1 mark, Oct 2025) — Use the correct tense form of the verbs given in the brackets. She —— to visit ...
- **Q85** (2 marks, May 2024) — Write two uses of Future tense.
- **Q131** (5 marks, Aug 2023) — List the uses of Simple Future Tense with suitable examples.

3.4.5 Twelve Tense Forms — Reference Table

Theory

The table below summarises all twelve tense forms with structure and typical use. Memorise structures for exam transformation and error-spotting questions.

Important Points

Tense	Simple	Continuous	Perfect	Perfect Continuous
Present	go/goes — habit, truth	is/am/are going — now	has/have gone — recent, since/for	has/have been going — duration to now
Past	went — definite past	was/were going — ongoing past	had gone — earlier past	had been going — past duration
Future	will/shall go — prediction	will be going — ongoing future	will have gone — before future point	will have been going — duration to future point

- **Non-conclusive verbs** avoid continuous: know, believe, want, like, seem, own, hear, see (except special meanings: I am seeing my lawyer tomorrow)
- **Since/for:** since + point in time (since 2018); for + duration (for twenty years) — with perfect tenses
- **By + future time:** Future Perfect — By 2022, Leena **will have been living** in Delhi for twenty years
-  She **is knowing** the answer. →  She **knows** the answer.
-  I **am living** here since 2010. →  I **have lived/have been living** here since 2010.

-  When I reached, he **already left**. →  he **had already left** (Past Perfect)
- "The earth **revolves** around the sun." → Simple Present (universal truth)
- "By next year, she **will have completed** her degree." → Future Perfect

For Exam

English has twelve tense forms (three tenses × four aspects). Simple Present expresses habitual actions and universal truths. Present Continuous for actions now. Present Perfect for recent or continuing actions. Non-conclusive verbs (know, believe, want) avoid continuous forms. Past Perfect (had + past participle) shows action before another past action. Future Perfect shows completion before a future deadline. Since/for used with perfect tenses.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q157** (5 marks, May 2024) — Choose the correct tense forms of the verbs given in brackets and fill in the blank...

Unit Recap (from SLM)

- 12 tense forms; non-conclusive verbs; since/for with perfect tenses
- Universal truth → Simple Present; action now → Present Continuous
- Past Perfect for earlier past; Future Perfect for completion before future point

Block 4: Basics of Writing in Communication

Unit 1: Fundamental Approach to Writing

4.1.1.1 Content

TheoryContent is the essence of writing — the ideas, information and messages conveyed. Without meaningful content, form and style cannot compensate.

Important Points

- Content = **what** is written — ideas, facts, arguments, stories
- Creative content: personal expression, imagery, narrative
- Non-creative content: concepts, instructions, factual information

- Planning stage identifies and develops content before drafting
- Content must match purpose and audience

For Exam

Content is the essence of writing — what is communicated. It includes ideas, information and arguments. Planning/prewriting stage develops content before organisation and drafting.

4.1.1.2 Form

TheoryForm refers to how and where writing appears — the medium and genre shaping the work.

Important Points

- Form = **how/where** writing appears — genre and medium
- Examples: screenplay, sonnet, novel, essay, report, memo, email, letter
- Form determines conventions — report format vs poem structure
- Choosing appropriate form for audience and purpose

For Exam

Form is how and where writing appears — screenplay, sonnet, novel, report, memo. Each form has conventions governing structure and presentation.

4.1.1.3 Structure

TheoryStructure is the organisational pattern — how content is arranged for clarity and impact.

Important Points

- Structure = **organisational pattern** — introduction, body, conclusion
- Essays: intro → body paragraphs → conclusion
- Reports: front matter → body → back matter
- Chronological, thematic, compare-contrast, cause-effect patterns
- Organising (step 2 of writing process) arranges structure

For Exam

Structure is the organisational pattern of writing. Essays use introduction-body-

conclusion; reports use front matter, body and back matter. Organising step arranges thoughts into structure.

4.1.1.4 Style

Theory Style is the manner of writing — tone, word choice, sentence length and voice that distinguish one writer from another.

Important Points

- Style = **manner of writing** — formal, conversational, aphoristic, descriptive
- Bacon's aphoristic style vs Lamb's conversational style
- Academic style: formal, objective, precise vocabulary
- Creative style: expressive, figurative, personal voice
- Style must suit audience, purpose and form
- **Why style is significant (Q92):** shapes how ideas are expressed; affects clarity, tone, reader engagement and effectiveness of communication

For Exam

Style is the manner of writing — formal, conversational, aphoristic or descriptive. Bacon's formal aphoristic style contrasts with Lamb's personal conversational style. Style suits audience and purpose. Style is significant because it shapes clarity, tone, engagement and communicative effectiveness.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q92** (2 marks, May 2024) — Why is Style in writing significant?

4.1.1 Creative and Non-creative Writing

Theory

Writing originated ~6000 years ago in Egypt and Mesopotamia — evolved from pictures to phonetic symbols and alphabet. Writing communicates thoughts across time and space. Four elements shape any written work: content, form, structure and style.

Important Points

- **Content:** essence — what is written; the ideas and information conveyed
- **Form:** how/where it appears — screenplay, sonnet, novel, report, memo

- **Structure:** organisational pattern — introduction, body, conclusion; chapters; sections
- **Style:** manner of writing — formal, conversational, aphoristic, descriptive
- **Creative writing:** unique, expressive, reveals rather than informs — poetry, short stories, novels, personal essays
- **Non-creative writing:** instructs, adds knowledge — history, science, religion textbooks
- Non-creative writing deals with concepts and is intended to instruct

For Exam

Four elements of writing: content (essence/what), form (medium/format), structure (organisation) and style (manner). Creative writing reveals (poetry, fiction); non-creative writing informs (textbooks). Content is the essence of what is written.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q111** (2 marks, Apr 2025) 🔥 — What is the fundamental approach to writing, and why is it important?

4.1.2 Process of Writing

Theory

The SLM presents a **five-step writing process** from planning through revision. Each step builds on the previous, transforming raw ideas into polished communication.

Important Points

- **1. Planning/Prewriting:** conceptualising ideas; brainstorming; choosing topic and audience
- **2. Organising:** arranging thoughts; creating outline; sequencing arguments
- **3. Writing/Drafting:** putting ideas on paper; first complete version
- **4. Editing:** checking draft for errors; improving clarity; adding linking devices
- **5. Revising:** improving based on feedback; final refinement after editing
- Organising = arranging thoughts (step 2); Revising follows editing (step 5)

- Example flow: brainstorm "Social Media and Youth" → outline intro/body/conclusion → draft → edit grammar → revise from feedback

For Exam

The five-step writing process: (1) Planning/Prewriting, (2) Organising (arranging thoughts), (3) Writing/Drafting, (4) Editing, (5) Revising. Organising arranges thoughts; revising follows editing. Creative writing reveals; non-creative informs.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q52** (1 mark, Apr 2025) — What is the first step in the writing process?
- **Q198** (10 marks, Apr 2025) 🔥 — Discuss the fundamental approach and process involved in writing.

4.1.2.1 Planning and Organising

Theory **Planning/Prewriting** conceptualises ideas; **Organising** arranges them into logical sequence before drafting.

Important Points

- **Planning/Prewriting:** brainstorm topics; identify audience and purpose; gather ideas; freewriting; mind maps
- **Organising:** create outline; sequence arguments; group related ideas; decide paragraph order
- Organising = **arranging thoughts** (exam answer for step 2)
- Essay outline before writing prevents disorganised drafts
- Report outline: define sections before data collection completes

For Exam

Planning/Prewriting conceptualises ideas through brainstorming and research. Organising arranges thoughts into outline and logical sequence — the second step of the writing process.

4.1.2.2 Drafting, Editing and Revising

Theory **Drafting** puts ideas on paper; **Editing** checks for errors and improves clarity; **Revising** refines based on feedback — revising follows editing.

Important Points

- **Drafting:** first complete version; focus on getting ideas down; don't perfection-edit while drafting
- **Editing:** grammar, spelling, punctuation; linking devices (however, therefore, moreover); clarity and coherence
- **Revising:** improve content and structure based on feedback; final refinement **after** editing
- After editing → **revising** (exam sequence question)
- Linking devices ensure smooth transitions between paragraphs

For Exam

Drafting produces the first complete version. Editing checks grammar, clarity and linking devices. Revising improves based on feedback and follows editing. Final draft has most clarity and accuracy.

Unit Recap (from SLM)

- Creative vs non-creative writing; content, form, structure, style
- Five steps: plan, organise, draft, edit, revise

Unit 2: Process involved in Answering Questions

4.2.1 Steps to Answer Questions

Theory

Answering questions — in exams and professionally — requires organised, structured responses. Writing everything you know without addressing the question directly is a common mistake.

Important Points

- **8 steps:** (1) Take thinking time (2) Understand the question (3) Address directly (4) Structure answer — intro-body-conclusion (5) Use simple language (6) Chunk lengthy answers (7) Balanced approach — multiple viewpoints (8) Revisit and check completeness
- First step: **take thinking time** — read question twice, identify key terms
- Do not write everything you know for direct questions
- Open-ended exam answers: simple, structured style with introduction, body paragraphs and conclusion

- Balanced approach: present multiple viewpoints where appropriate
- Revisit answer before submitting — check completeness and relevance
- **MCQ stem (Q69):** the main question or problem statement in a multiple choice question — the part before the options

For Exam

Eight steps to answer questions: think, understand, address directly, structure (intro-body-conclusion), use simple language, chunk long answers, take balanced approach and revisit. First step is taking thinking time. Structure answers clearly rather than dumping all known information. In MCQs, the **stem** is the main question/problem before the options.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q69** (1 mark, Oct 2025) — What is the stem in a multiple choice question?
- **Q141** (5 marks, May 2024) — How to develop a plan for writing the answers to the questions for examination?
- **Q182** (5 marks, Oct 2025) — Elucidate on the method to be followed for answering a problem-solving question.

4.2.1.1 Oral vs Written Communication — Exam Comparison

Theory

Oral and written communication differ in permanence, feedback, formality and clarity. Both are essential skills tested in short-answer and long-answer sections.

Important Points

Feature	Oral Communication	Written Communication
Medium	Spoken word — face-to-face, phone	Written word — email, letter, report
Feedback	Immediate — tone, gesture help	Delayed — no instant clarification
Record	Ephemeral unless recorded	Permanent, can be revised
Formality	Less formal; conversational	More formal; follows conventions
Non-verbal	Tone, gesture, expression support meaning	Punctuation, formatting convey tone

Feature	Oral Communication	Written Communication
Examples	Interview, lecture, telephone call	Email, memo, report, application letter
Advantage	Quick, personal, emotional nuance	Precise, documented, revisable

- Oral: immediate feedback; tone and gesture help understanding
- Written: permanent record; more formal; can be revised before sending
- Email = primary **formal written** platform today (exam answer)
- Declining job application requires **written email** with professional structure

For Exam

Oral communication offers immediate feedback with tone and gesture support but is ephemeral. Written communication provides a permanent, formal record suitable for emails, reports and applications. Email is the primary formal written platform. Both require clarity but written communication allows revision before delivery.

4.2.2 Email Responses

Theory

Email is the primary formal written communication platform today — for meetings, applications, customer service and official correspondence. Professional emails follow structured format with appropriate tone.

Important Points

- **Email structure:** subject line, greeting, body, closing, signature
- **Acknowledgement emails:** confirm receipt of message/application
- **Automated response:** pre-set reply for common queries without human intervention
- **Approving/declining applications:** professional tone; clear decision; compliment opening; good-luck closing if declining
- Opening line of body: **Greeting**
- Company details: attachment or link
- "If you would like further information..." placed in **conclusion**

- Declining job — opening: compliment/thank applicant; closing: good-luck wish
- Sample decline: thank interest → regret decision → encourage future applications → Yours sincerely
- Avoid: vague answers, unjustifiable arguments, informal tone in official emails

For Exam

Email is the primary formal communication platform. Two broad response types: acknowledgement and automated response (also approve/decline). Structure: subject, greeting, body, closing, signature. Declining applications requires professional tone, clear decision and courteous closing.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q41** (1 mark, May 2024) — What are the two types of response mails?
- **Q147** (5 marks, May 2024) — What are the different types of acknowledgments for Emails?
- **Q179** (5 marks, Oct 2025) — Compose a reply email for a business product inquiry, including wholesale prices, ...
- **Q196** (10 marks, May 2024) — Explain the two types of email responses with examples.

Unit Recap (from SLM)

- Eight steps for answering questions; intro-body-conclusion
- Email: acknowledge, approve, decline; subject, greeting, body, closing

Unit 3: Use Vocabulary to Express Thoughts

4.3.1 Vocabulary and Word Knowledge

Theory

Vocabulary comprises words known and used. Words and thoughts are two sides of a coin — vocabulary richness shapes expression and thinking quality. Developing vocabulary is essential for academic and professional writing.

Important Points

- **Active vocabulary:** words used in own speech and writing

- **Passive vocabulary:** words understood when others use them but not actively produced
- **Basic, high-frequency, low-frequency:** everyday words vs rare/specialised terms; mid-frequency between the two
- **Low-frequency vocabulary:** rare/specialised words not used in everyday conversation; understood by fewer people
- **Emotional vocabulary:** words naming feelings precisely — happiness, joy, grief, anger, fear, anxiety, loneliness, envy, gratitude
- **Loneliness words (Q122):** isolation, solitude, alienation, desolation — *After moving to a new city, she felt a deep sense of solitude.*
- **Astronomy (Q17):** branch of knowledge that deals with space
- Taking risks with new words improves vocabulary power
- Keep vocabulary records; learn collocations; use dictionaries regularly
- Negative/positive energy of words affects mood and communication impact

For Exam

Active vocabulary = words you use; passive = words you understand but don't use. High-frequency = everyday words; low-frequency = rare/specialised. Emotional vocabulary names feelings precisely (anxious, solitude, gratitude). Astronomy = study of space. Taking risks with vocabulary improves learning.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q17** (1 mark, May 2024) — Name the branch of knowledge that deals with space.
- **Q40** (1 mark, May 2024) — Vocabulary where the words appear in users' spoken and written contexts is called ...
- **Q75** (2 marks, Aug 2023) — What is active vocabulary?
- **Q93** (2 marks, May 2024) ★ — Explain Active and Passive vocabulary.
- **Q96** (2 marks, May 2024) — What is passive vocabulary?
- **Q121** (2 marks, Oct 2025) — What is a low frequency vocabulary?
- **Q122** (2 marks, Oct 2025) — Write down four words to express loneliness and use one of them in a sentence.

- **Q180** (5 marks, Oct 2025) — Briefly explain emotional vocabulary with examples.

4.3.2 Word Usage and Collocations

Theory

Correct word choice and collocation distinguish fluent writing from awkward expression. Related word forms (adjective/noun/verb) must be used in appropriate grammatical contexts.

Important Points

- **fond vs fondness:** She is **fond** of classical music (adjective); His **fondness** for cricket began in childhood (noun)
- **Collocations:** make a decision (not *do a decision*); heavy rain (not *strong rain*)
- Synonym upgrade improves style: good → excellent; sad → melancholy; said → argued/explained
- **Synonym for "fast" (Q57):** quick, rapid, swift, speedy
- Important tasks: vocabulary records, dictionary use, learning word grammar, taking risks with new words
- Word choice/register affects formal vs informal communication
- **Word-pair usage (Q186):**

Pair	Usage	Example
hard / hardly	hard = with effort; hardly = scarcely/almost not	He works hard . / He hardly works.
late / lately	late = after expected time; lately = recently	He arrived late . / I have lately been busy.
still / yet	still = continuing; yet = until now (negative)	She is still waiting. / He has not come yet .
drown / sink	drown = die in water; sink = go down below surface	The ship sank . / He drowned in the river.
too...to	excess prevents action	He is too young to drive.
enough...to	sufficient for action	She is old enough to vote.

For Exam

Correct vocabulary usage includes knowing word forms (fond/fondness) and

collocations (make a decision, heavy rain). Know pairs: hard/hardly, late/lately, still/yet, drown/sink, too...to/enough...to. Synonym for fast: quick/rapid/swift. Regular dictionary use and vocabulary records support development.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q57** (1 mark, Apr 2025) — What is the synonym for "fast"?
- **Q112** (2 marks, Apr 2025) — How can a writer effectively use vocabulary to express thoughts?
- **Q186** (10 marks, Aug 2023) — Discuss the correct usages of the following pairs of words and phrases with suitab...

Unit Recap (from SLM)

- Active/passive vocabulary; high/low frequency; emotional vocabulary
 - Collocations; word forms; dictionary use
-

Block 5: Summary, Essays and Reports

Unit 1: Summary Vs Précis

5.1.1 Summary Writing

Theory

A **summary** is a condensed form of a long text sharing the same meaning. It is usually one page or less, can be written or spoken, requires **no heading** and includes **no personal opinions**. Summary writing improves reading skills and retention.

Important Points

- **Summary process:** read thoroughly → identify main ideas → omit examples/repetitions → write in own words → check same meaning preserved
- Usually ≤ one page; covers all main points briefly
- No heading required; can be oral or written
- No personal opinions allowed
- Improves reading skills and comprehension

- Omit examples, repetitions and minor details

For Exam

A summary is a condensed version covering essential information in the writer's own words. It has no heading, may be spoken or written, and excludes personal opinions. Process: read, identify main ideas, omit details, write concisely, verify meaning preserved.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q143** (5 marks, May 2024) — Write the summary of a book you have read recently.
- **Q172** (5 marks, Apr 2025) — What is summary writing, and what are its key components? Explain.

5.1.1.1 Process of Summary Writing

Theory

Summary writing follows a systematic process to preserve meaning while reducing length.

Important Points

- **Step 1:** Read entire text thoroughly — understand full scope
- **Step 2:** Identify main ideas and central themes — distinguish from examples
- **Step 3:** Omit examples, repetitions, minor details and digressions
- **Step 4:** Write in own words — do not copy phrases verbatim
- **Step 5:** Check completeness — same meaning preserved; usually $\leq$ one page
- No heading; no personal opinions; may be oral or written
- Improves reading skills and retention of key information

For Exam

Summary writing process: read thoroughly, identify main ideas, omit examples and repetitions, write in own words, verify meaning preserved. No heading or opinions. Usually one page or less.

5.1.2 Précis Writing

Theory

A **précis** is shorter than a summary, giving only absolutely important points. It is **always written, has a heading** and excludes personal opinions. Ideal length is approximately **one-third** of the original.

Important Points

- **Précis process:** read carefully → find central theme → count words → draft within 1/3 original → give suitable title → final check
- Must have **apt heading/title** at the beginning
- Always written; ideally one paragraph
- No personal opinions; no ideas outside original passage
- **Cambridge Advanced Learner's Dictionary (Q70):** a short form of a text that gives only the important ideas (*brief summary giving essential points only*)
- Mark Twain example: "I have had a lot of worries in my life, most of which never happened" → précis: **"I overthink."**
- Improves analytical skill and vocabulary
- Worked example — Original: "Democracy is not merely a form of government. It is a way of life..." → Title: **Democracy as Way of Life** → Précis: "Democracy is a way of life ensuring equality, diversity and citizen participation."

For Exam

Précis presents only the crux of a passage in about one-third of original length. Cambridge dictionary: a short form of a text giving only the important ideas. It must have a heading, is always written, and excludes opinions. Mark Twain worry quote condenses to "I overthink." Précis improves analytical skills.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q70** (1 mark, Oct 2025) — How does the Cambridge Advanced Learner's Dictionary define précis?

5.1.2.1 Process of Précis Writing

Theory

Précis writing demands analytical reduction to essential points within strict length limits.

Important Points

- **Step 1:** Read passage carefully — identify central theme
- **Step 2:** Count words of original — target $\approx$ one-third length
- **Step 3:** Highlight absolutely essential points only — omit all non-crucial details
- **Step 4:** Draft with suitable **heading/title** at beginning
- **Step 5:** Write in own words — brevity, clarity, grammatical accuracy
- **Step 6:** Revise — check no ideas outside original; no personal opinions
- Précis **will have a heading** at the beginning (exam answer)
- Ideal: one paragraph; one-third of original word count

For Exam

Précis process: read carefully, count words, identify crux, draft with heading at one-third length, revise for accuracy. Must have heading; no opinions; no external ideas. Improves analytical and vocabulary skills.

5.1.3 Summary vs Précis — Comparison

Theory

Both summary and précis condense texts, but they differ in scope, format and purpose. Understanding these differences is essential for exam short-answer and practical questions.

Important Points

Feature	Summary	Précis
Scope	All main points briefly	Only absolutely essential points (~1/3 length)
Heading	No heading	Must have apt title
Format	Written or spoken	Always written
Opinions	No personal opinions	No personal opinions
Purpose	General condensation	Analytical reduction to crux

- Condensation saves time and energy; develops clear, direct language
- Précis improves analytical skill; summary improves reading skill
- Neither allows personal opinions or external ideas

For Exam

Summary covers all main points briefly without heading and may be spoken. Précis gives only the crux, always has a heading, is always written and targets one-third of original length. Both exclude personal opinions. Mark Twain example précis: "I overthink."

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q56** (1 mark, Apr 2025) 🔥 — How is precis writing different from summarization?
- **Q140** (5 marks, May 2024, Apr 2025) ★🔥 — Difference between Summary and Précis.

Unit Recap (from SLM)

- Summary: no heading, can be spoken; précis: has heading, always written, ~1/3 length
- Both: no opinions; condensation saves time
- Mark Twain → "I overthink."

Unit 2: Writing Abstract

5.2.1 Abstract Writing

Theory

An **abstract** is a brief comprehensive summary giving overview of a text — used for theses, research papers, journals and conference papers. APA defines it as a "brief, comprehensive summary of contents." Readers decide whether to read the full text based on the abstract.

Important Points

- **Word limit:** ≤ ~300 words; shorter than summary
- **Abstract vs Introduction:** introduction gives detailed background; abstract = brief self-contained overview of entire paper
- **Abstract vs Summary:** abstract presents only crux; summary presents entire text in nutshell
- **Good abstract features:** stand-alone (understandable without reading paper); maximum clarity and economy

- **Keywords:** indexing terms for search engines and retrieval — essential for academic databases
- **Structured abstract (IMRaD):** Introduction, Methods, Results, Discussion
- **Unstructured abstract:** single paragraph covering aim, methodology, results, conclusion
- Must include: research aim, methodology, results, conclusion

For Exam

An abstract is a condensed overview (≤ 300 words) of a research paper or thesis. It is self-contained, includes keywords for indexing, and differs from introduction (detailed background). IMRaD format: Introduction, Methods, Results, Discussion. Used so readers can decide whether to read the full paper.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q84** (2 marks, Aug 2023, Oct 2025) ★🔥 — Differentiate between abstract and summary.
- **Q113** (2 marks, Apr 2025) — What is abstract writing, and how does it differ from other forms of writing?
- **Q123** (2 marks, Oct 2025) — Write any two features of a good abstract.
- **Q181** (5 marks, Oct 2025) — Differentiate between abstract and summary.

Unit Recap (from SLM)

- Abstract ≤ 300 words; keywords for indexing; self-contained
- Differs from introduction and summary
- IMRaD: Introduction, Methods, Results, Discussion

Unit 3: Essays

5.3.1 History and Nature of the Essay

Theory

An **essay** is a written composition sharing the writer's information or views on a topic. **Michel de Montaigne** is the Father of Essays — he pioneered the personal reflective form in the 16th century.

Important Points

- **Montaigne** = Father of Essays
- Essay = written composition on a topic expressing writer's views or information
- First step in essay writing: **collection of material and data**
- Essay process: (1) Collect material (2) Plan/outline (3) Write draft (4) Revise and edit
- Three-part structure: **Introduction** (thesis, background) → **Body** (arguments, examples) → **Conclusion** (summary, final thought)

For Exam

An essay is a written composition on a topic. Montaigne is the Father of Essays. First step is collecting material. Structure: introduction with thesis, body with arguments and examples, conclusion with final thought.

5.3.2 Types of Essays

Theory

Essays are classified by purpose and style into personal, formal, argumentative, analytical, descriptive, expository and reflective types. Each type serves a distinct communicative goal.

Important Points

- **Personal/Informal:** subjective, conversational — **Charles Lamb** (*Essays of Elia*)
- **Formal/Baconian:** impersonal, didactic — **Francis Bacon** (aphoristic style)
- **Argumentative:** presents argument with evidence — Mathew L. Sanders *Becoming a Learner*
- **Analytical:** examines deeper levels of text/topic — Rossetti imagery analysis
- **Descriptive:** vivid detailing of situation, person or object — monsoon morning in Kerala
- **Expository:** explains/informs objectively — no author opinion; factual (photosynthesis)
- **Reflective/Philosophical:** profound universal themes — life, death, morality

- Expository = factual, no author opinion; Personal = personal experience/story

For Exam

Essay types: personal/informal (Charles Lamb), formal/Baconian (Francis Bacon), argumentative (evidence-based), analytical (deeper analysis), descriptive (vivid detail), expository (objective explanation) and reflective/philosophical (universal themes). Sanders' "Becoming a Learner" is argumentative.

5.3.2.1 Personal and Formal Essays

Theory **Personal essays** are subjective and conversational; **formal (Baconian) essays** are impersonal and didactic with aphoristic style.

Important Points

- **Personal/Informal:** Charles Lamb — *Essays of Elia*; personal experience, conversational tone, humour
- **Formal/Baconian:** Francis Bacon — impersonal, didactic, aphoristic (short wise statements)
- Personal = personal experience/story; Formal = impersonal instruction
- Lamb famous for personal essays (exam answer)
- Bacon's essays teach moral and practical wisdom concisely

For Exam

Charles Lamb is famous for personal/informal essays (*Essays of Elia*). Francis Bacon wrote formal/Baconian essays — impersonal, didactic and aphoristic. Personal essays use subjective voice; formal essays instruct objectively.

5.3.2.2 Argumentative and Analytical Essays

Theory **Argumentative essays** present a claim with evidence; **analytical essays** examine deeper levels of a text or topic.

Important Points

- **Argumentative:** thesis + evidence + counter-arguments — Mathew L. Sanders *Becoming a Learner*; presents arguments on a debatable topic with evidence for a clear position

- **Persuasive essay (Q95):** argues a viewpoint and tries to convince the reader to agree (*related to / often overlapping with argumentative*)
- **Analytical:** deeper examination — Rossetti's imagery in *The Blessed Damozel*; how meaning is constructed
- Argumentative: "Should college focus on skills or learning?" — present both sides with evidence
- Analytical ≠ book review — explains *how* not just *what*
- Both require clear thesis and organised body paragraphs

For Exam

Argumentative essays present arguments with evidence for a clear position (Sanders' *Becoming a Learner*). Persuasive essays argue a viewpoint to convince the reader. Analytical essays examine deeper levels of texts or topics and explain how meaning is constructed, not merely summarise.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q95** (2 marks, May 2024) — What is a persuasive essay?
- **Q124** (2 marks, Oct 2025) — What is an argumentative essay?

5.3.2.3 Descriptive, Expository and Reflective Essays

Theory **Descriptive** essays create vivid pictures; **expository** essays explain objectively; **reflective/philosophical** essays explore universal themes.

Important Points

- **Descriptive:** vivid detailing — monsoon morning in Kerala; sensory language
- **Expository:** explains/informs objectively — no author opinion; factual (how photosynthesis works)
- **Reflective/Philosophical:** profound universal themes — life, death, morality, existence
- Expository = factual, no author opinion (exam answer)
- Descriptive uses imagery, adjectives, figurative language
- Reflective essays draw on personal meditation on universal questions

For Exam

Descriptive essays use vivid detail (monsoon scene). Expository essays explain objectively without author opinion. Reflective/philosophical essays address profound universal themes like life, death and morality.

5.3.3 Essay Structure and Features

Theory

Key features of a good essay include clear thesis, organised paragraphs, evidence and examples, coherent flow and appropriate register. Planning before writing prevents disorganised drafts.

Important Points

- **Key features:** clear thesis, organised paragraphs, evidence/examples, coherent flow, appropriate register, unity, adequate development, conclusion
- **Any one for 1-mark (Q71):** Clear thesis / logical structure / coherence / unity / adequate development / conclusion
- **Introduction:** hook, background, thesis statement
- **Body:** 2-3 paragraphs with arguments, examples, analysis; linking devices between paragraphs
- **Conclusion:** summary of main points, final thought, no new arguments
- Outline example — “Impact of Social Media on Youth”: hook (3+ hours daily) → positive effects → negative effects → balanced use → conclusion on responsible digital citizenship
- ~300 words for practice assignments

For Exam

A good essay has introduction (thesis), body (arguments with evidence) and conclusion (final thought). Key features: clear thesis, organised paragraphs, coherent flow, unity, adequate development. Plan outline before drafting. Model topic: social media impact on youth with balanced arguments.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q71** (1 mark, Oct 2025) — Mention any key feature of a good essay.

Unit Recap (from SLM)

- Montaigne = Father of Essays; Charles Lamb = personal; Bacon = formal
- Types: argumentative, analytical, descriptive, expository, reflective
- Structure: introduction, body, conclusion

Unit 4: Reports

5.4.1 Nature and Purpose of Reports

Theory

Report (Latin *reportare* = to carry back) is formal writing presenting information about past events. It answers five **wh- questions**: who, what, when, where, why (and how). Reports serve as repositories of information for decision-making.

Important Points

- **Latin origin:** *reportare* (to carry back)
- **Five wh- questions:** who, what, when, where, why (how)
- **Key features:** states all facts (pleasant and unpleasant); specific purpose; credible from firsthand observation; essential information only
- **Repository of information** — reliable record for future reference
- Caesar's concise report: "**Veni, vidi, vici**" (I came, I saw, I conquered)
- Separate facts from opinions; use active voice; concise sentences

For Exam

A report describes past events answering who, what, when, where, why. Latin origin *reportare* means to carry back. Reports are repositories of information presenting facts objectively. Caesar's "Veni, vidi, vici" exemplifies concise reporting.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q114** (2 marks, Apr 2025, May 2024) ★ — Define report writing.

5.4.2 Oral vs Written Reports

Theory

Reports are classified as oral or written. Written reports are more permanent,

objective and reliable for future decisions; oral reports allow immediate clarification but are ephemeral and subjective.

Important Points

- **Oral:** spoken, subjective, ephemeral, immediate clarification possible
- **Written:** permanent, objective, reliable for future decisions, more formal
- Two broad classifications: **Informal** and **Formal**
- Written reports preferred for official and legal documentation

For Exam

Oral reports are spoken and ephemeral; written reports are permanent and objective. Both answer the five wh- questions. Written reports are more reliable for institutional decision-making.

5.4.2.1 Oral vs Written Reports — Comparison

Theory

Reports may be delivered orally or in writing. Each mode has distinct advantages. Written reports are preferred for official documentation; oral reports suit immediate briefings.

Important Points

Feature	Oral Report	Written Report
Medium	Spoken word	Written document
Permanence	Ephemeral — not permanently recorded	Permanent record
Tone	Subjective; speaker's interpretation	Objective; factual
Feedback	Immediate clarification possible	Delayed; requires follow-up
Reliability	Less reliable for future reference	More reliable for decisions
Formality	Less formal	More formal
Examples	Meeting briefing, verbal presentation	Memo, letter report, formal report

- Two classifications of reports: **Oral and Written** (exam answer)
- Written reports answer five wh- questions with documented evidence
- Repository of information = **report** (exam answer)

- Informal written reports: letter report and memo report

For Exam

Oral reports are spoken, subjective and ephemeral with immediate feedback. Written reports are permanent, objective and more reliable for future decisions. Both are report classifications. Written informal types: letter report and memo report. Reports serve as repositories of information.

5.4.3 Informal Reports

Theory Informal reports (short reports) address immediate needs, typically under ten pages, for internal audiences. Two types: letter reports and memo reports.

Important Points

- **Letter report:** business letter format, 4-5 pages — letterhead, date, address, subject, salutation, body, findings, conclusion, complimentary close, signature
- **Memo report:** inter-office memorandum, 2-3 pages — To, From, Date, Subject, introduction, body, closing, signature
- Memo = faster inter-office communication; letter = more formal external format
- Sample memo: To MD, From HR Manager, Subject employee issues — findings on training, transport, salary; recommendations
- Informal reports also called **short reports**

For Exam

Informal reports include letter reports (business letter format, 4-5 pages) and memo reports (To/From/Date/Subject, 2-3 pages). Memo format suits internal communication; letter format for formal correspondence. Both address immediate informational needs.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q100** (2 marks, May 2024) — What is an informal report? Mention the two types.

5.4.4 Formal Reports

Theory **Formal reports** are official, analytical or informational documents with detailed structure. Types include routine, special, investigative/research and status quo reports.

Important Points

- **Routine reports:** issued at regular intervals — daily, weekly, monthly, quarterly, annual
- **Progress report (Q72):** details the progress of work completed during a specific period; a type of routine report issued at regular intervals
- **Special reports:** prepared for specific occasion
- **Investigative/Research/Interpretive reports:** analytical; also called recommendatory reports — analyse and recommend
- **Status quo/Informational reports:** present current situation / facts without recommendations
- **Informational vs Interpretive (Q158):** Informational = present facts/status quo; Interpretive = analyse + conclusions + recommendations
- **Formal structure:** Title page, Letter of transmittal, Table of contents, Executive summary, Introduction, Body/Findings, Conclusions, Recommendations, Appendices, Bibliography
- **Framework:** Front matter, main body, back matter; copyright notice in front matter
- **Data collection:** personal/telephonic interview, surveys, observations, lab experiments
- **Graphic aids:** tables, bar/pie graphs, charts, maps, photographs

For Exam

Formal reports include routine (regular intervals — including **progress reports** on work completed in a period), special (specific occasion) and investigative/interpretive types. Informational reports present facts; interpretive reports analyse and recommend. Structure includes front matter, main body (findings, conclusions, recommendations) and back matter. Data collected via interviews, surveys and observations.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q170** (5 marks, Apr 2025) 🔥 — What is report writing, and what are the different types of reports commonly used ...

- **Q195** (10 marks, May 2024, Apr 2025) ★🔥 — Explain the different types of reports.

5.4.4.1 Formal Report Structure

Theory

Formal reports follow a standard framework divided into front matter, main body and back matter. This structure ensures completeness, professionalism and ease of reference for decision-makers.

Important Points

Section	Components	Purpose
Front matter	Title page, letter of transmittal, table of contents, executive summary, copyright notice	Introduce and navigate the report
Main body	Introduction, methodology, findings, analysis, conclusions, recommendations	Present research and results
Back matter	Appendices, bibliography, glossary, index	Support material and references

- **Routine reports:** daily, weekly, monthly, quarterly, annual — issued at regular intervals
- **Special reports:** prepared for specific occasion or event
- **Investigative/Interpretive/Recommendatory:** analytical with suggested actions
- **Status quo/Informational:** presents current situation without recommendations
- **Data collection:** personal interview, telephonic interview, surveys, observations, lab experiments
- **Graphic aids:** tables, bar/pie graphs, charts, maps, photographs, drawings
- Separate **facts from opinions**; use **active voice**; concise sentences

For Exam

Formal report structure: front matter (title page, transmittal letter, contents, executive summary), main body (introduction, findings, conclusions, recommendations) and back matter (appendices, bibliography). Types: routine

(regular intervals), special (specific occasion), investigative/interpretive. Data via interviews, surveys, observations. Copyright notice in front matter.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q72** (1 mark, Oct 2025) — What type of report details the progress of work completed during a specific perio...
- **Q158** (5 marks, May 2024) — Compare and contrast interpretive reports and informational reports.

5.4.5 Report Writing Process

Theory

Report writing follows systematic steps from defining purpose through data collection, drafting and revision. Objective factual tone distinguishes reports from essays.

Important Points

- **Process:** (1) Define objective, scope, purpose (2) Collect data — encyclopaedia, textbooks, journals, internet, interviews, surveys (3) Prepare outline (4) Write drafts — separate facts from opinions (5) Use active voice (6) Add tables/figures (7) Revise and finalise
- Newspaper report: headline, byline, lead paragraph (most important info first — inverted pyramid)
- Objective factual tone throughout
- Answer all five wh- questions in body
- Conclude with clear recommendations where appropriate

For Exam

Report writing process: define purpose, collect data, outline, draft, add visual aids, revise. Use active voice and objective tone. Separate facts from opinions. Newspaper reports use inverted pyramid — most important information in lead paragraph.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q102** (2 marks, May 2024) — What are the different methods of data collection for writing a report?

Unit Recap (from SLM)

- Report: who, what, when, where, why; informal (letter, memo) and formal
- Routine, special, investigative types; front matter, body, back matter
- Memo: To/From/Date/Subject; objective tone; active voice

Unit 5: Editing and Proofreading

5.5.1 Editing and Proofreading

Theory **Editing** improves clarity, precision, accuracy and effectiveness of written work. **Proofreading** is the final step, checking surface-level errors. ESL (English as Second Language) users benefit most from systematic editing.

Important Points

- **Editing:** rearranges ideas; ensures coherence using **linking devices** (however, therefore, moreover, firstly, in conclusion); checks grammar, spelling, punctuation
- **Proofreading:** final step of editing; checks **surface-level errors** — spelling, punctuation, typos, formatting; ensures clarity and professionalism before submission
- **Benefits of editing (Q128):** improves clarity, precision, accuracy and effectiveness; ensures coherence with linking devices; removes errors; produces better final draft; ESL users benefit most
- **Ten steps of editing (Q156):**
 1. Take a break after drafting
 2. Read the draft objectively
 3. Check overall structure and organisation
 4. Improve clarity and coherence (linking devices)
 5. Check grammar and sentence structure
 6. Check spelling and punctuation
 7. Verify facts and data
 8. Remove unnecessary words/repetition
 9. Read aloud to catch errors
 10. Final proofread for surface-level errors

- **Final draft** has most clarity, precision and accuracy
- **Proofreading tips:** read objectively; take breaks; use grammar book/dictionary; read aloud; check one error type at a time
- **ESL users** benefit most from editing practice
- Editing exercise: ✗ Indias aspiration to **became** → ✓ India's aspiration to **become**; ✗ observed National Youth Day → ✓ observed **as** National Youth Day
- Linking devices example: Social media connects people. **However**, excessive use affects mental health. **Therefore**, students should set limits. **In conclusion**, balanced use is essential.

For Exam

Editing improves clarity, precision, accuracy and effectiveness using linking devices for coherence. **Ten steps:** break → read objectively → check structure → clarity/coherence → grammar → spelling/punctuation → verify facts → cut repetition → read aloud → final proofread. Proofreading is the final step checking surface errors. ESL users benefit most. Final draft is most effective.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q90** (2 marks, May 2024) 🔥 — Why is Proofreading an important part of writing?
- **Q128** (5 marks, Aug 2023) — Write a short note on the benefits of editing.
- **Q156** (5 marks, May 2024) 🔥 — What are the ten steps involved in the editing process?
- **Q171** (5 marks, Apr 2025) — Read the passage below and identify any mistakes in grammar, punctuation, or spell...

Unit Recap (from SLM)

- Editing → proofreading; linking devices; ESL benefit
- Final draft = most effective; surface-level errors in proofreading

Block 6: Practice, Practice, Practice

Unit 1: Reading Comprehension Passages

6.1.1 Comprehension Practice Skills

Theory

Block 6 applies Block 2 reading skills to practice passages. Comprehension practice develops ability to distinguish main ideas from supporting details, use skimming and scanning strategically, infer meaning from context and answer in complete sentences with textual evidence.

Important Points

- **Skills practised:** main idea vs supporting detail; skimming and scanning; context vocabulary; inference (reading between the lines)
- **Passage sources in SLM:** Gandhi's *Story of My Experiments with Truth* (Forward), historical passages, contemporary texts
- **Answer approach:** read passage twice → underline keywords → answer in complete sentences → support with evidence from text
- **Question types:** factual, inferential, vocabulary-in-context, theme/purpose
- Step 1: Skim for main topic (30 seconds); Step 2: Read carefully, underline topic sentences
- For inference: ask "What is implied but not stated?" — support with "The passage states that..."
- Vocabulary-in-context: read surrounding sentences for meaning clues

For Exam

Comprehension practice requires identifying main ideas, using context for unknown words, scanning for specific answers and inferring implied meanings. Always support answers with textual evidence in complete sentences. Read passage twice before answering.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q165** (5 marks, —) — Read the passage and answer the questions that follow — Title: "The Lost Key" *(Ap...

Unit Recap (from SLM)

- Main idea, inference, context vocabulary, textual evidence
- Read twice; complete sentence answers

Unit 2: Grammar and Vocabulary

6.2.1 Grammar Practice

Theory

Grammar practice consolidates Block 3 rules through error spotting, transformation and fill-in exercises. Common exam areas include concord, tenses, articles, question tags, reported speech and active/passive voice.

Important Points

- Practice areas: parts of speech identification, sentence correction, tense usage, concord, articles, prepositions, transformation
- ❌ He **don't** know → ✅ He **doesn't** know
- ❌ She **has went** → ✅ She **has gone**
- ❌ **An** university → ✅ **A** university
- ❌ **Informations** → ✅ **Information** (uncountable)
- ❌ **Each** of the girls **are** ready → ✅ **is** ready
- Reported speech: Mary, "I have been to London." → Mary said she **had been** to London.
- Articles: We heard **a** union minister; **an** electric fence
- Concord: A bunch of keys **is** missing; The committee **meets** every week

PYQ Model Answers (quick drills)

- **Fairly/rather:** The examination was **rather** difficult.
- **Adverb of manner:** Sarita walked **gracefully**. / Examples: quickly, slowly, happily, carefully
- **Lexical verbs:** main verbs with independent meaning (run, write, think) — not auxiliaries
- **Question:** He is a doctor. → **Is he a doctor?**
- **Voice:** The Principal will announce the results. → The results **will be announced** by the Principal. / The chef cooks the meal. → The meal **is cooked** by the chef.
- **Comparative:** Tharu is **taller** than Pathu.
- **Past participle:** He had **written** a play. / She **sang** beautifully. / My brother **went** to Mumbai.

- **Concord:** A pair of spectacles **is** on the table. / Neither the teacher nor the students **are**... / The people who **live** next door...
- **Articles:** **An** honest man is **the** noblest work of God.
- **Past perfect sequence:** When he **arrived**, the train **had left**.
- **Question tags:** He is a pilot, **isn't he?** / Let us go for a movie, **shall we?** / Megha studies well, **doesn't she?**
- **Prepositions:** made **of** silver / made **from** trees
- **Modal should (duty):** You **should** respect your elders. / Students **should** submit assignments on time.
- **Gerund as subject:** **Swimming** keeps you fit. / **Reading** improves vocabulary.
- **Reported speech fills:** had bought | couldn't | were going | looked | didn't speak
- **Tense fills (Q157):** have been learning | am reading | moves | found | am leaving / will leave
- **Concord fills (Q183):** is | is | is/are | was | is/were

For Exam

Grammar practice targets concord (each/every → singular), tenses (habit = simple present, not continuous), uncountable nouns (information not informations), articles (a university, an hour) and reported speech tense shifts. Memorise the PYQ model drills above for Section A/C.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q200** (10 marks, Apr 2025) — Discuss the different parts of speech in the English language. Explain each part o...

6.2.2 Vocabulary Practice

Theory

Vocabulary practice includes synonyms, antonyms, word formation, idioms and phrasal verbs. It reinforces Block 4 vocabulary development strategies.

Important Points

- Synonyms and antonyms strengthen expression variety
- Word formation: fond → fondness; act → action; happy → happiness

- Idioms and phrasal verbs require contextual learning — look up, give up, carry out
- Common error areas: uncountable nouns with plural forms; non-conclusive verbs in continuous
- Collocation practice: make progress, take responsibility, pay attention

For Exam

Vocabulary practice covers synonyms, antonyms, word formation and collocations. Combined with grammar error spotting, it prepares for Section A and B objective and short-answer questions.

Unit Recap (from SLM)

- Error spotting: concord, tenses, articles, uncountable nouns
- Reported speech, question tags, active/passive
- Vocabulary: collocations, word forms

Unit 3: Précis Practice

6.3.1 Précis Writing Practice

Theory

Précis practice applies Block 5 Unit 1 rules to newspaper and academic passages. SLM provides environmental/climate passages for condensation exercises.

Important Points

- **Steps:** read twice → find title/theme → count words → write 1/3 length → no opinions → use own words
- Checklist: heading present, within word limit, all key points included, no repetition, no external ideas
- Always add **heading**; reduce to approximately **one-third** of original
- Preserve core argument without personal views
- Read passage twice before writing; count words of original and target

For Exam

Précis practice: always add heading, reduce to one-third, preserve core

argument, no personal views. Read passage twice, count words, draft within limit and verify all essential points are included.

Unit Recap (from SLM)

- Heading mandatory; ~1/3 length; no opinions
- Read twice; count words; own words

Unit 4: Essay Writing Practice

6.4.1 Essay Writing Practice

Theory

Essay practice develops structured writing on contemporary topics from the SLM. Assignments typically require ~300 words with clear introduction, body and conclusion.

Important Points

- **SLM topics:** gender equality in education, social media impact, marital rape, dowry deaths, toxic parenting, refugee crisis
- **Format:** ~300 words; introduction with thesis; 2-3 body paragraphs; conclusion
- **Process:** brainstorm → outline → draft → edit → revise
- Balanced essays present multiple viewpoints before conclusion
- Use linking devices between paragraphs: however, moreover, therefore, in conclusion
- Model: "Impact of Social Media on Youth" — hook, positive effects, negative effects, balanced use, conclusion

For Exam

Essay practice uses SLM topics (gender equality, social media, women's rights, refugee crisis). Structure: introduction with thesis, 2-3 body paragraphs with evidence, conclusion. Plan outline before writing; target ~300 words.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q190** (10 marks, May 2024) — Write an essay on 'The Future of Artificial Intelligence in Education'.

- **Q199** (10 marks, —) — Write an essay on one of the following topics: (*April 2025*) 1. The Impact of Tec...

6.4.2 Sample Essay Outline — Social Media and Youth

Theory

A model essay outline demonstrates how to plan before writing — essential for Section D long answers and Block 6 assignments.

Important Points

- **Topic:** Impact of Social Media on Youth (~300 words)
- **Introduction:** Hook — youth spend 3+ hours daily online; thesis — social media reshapes communication, identity and mental health
- **Body 1 — Positive effects:** global connectivity; learning resources; entrepreneurship opportunities; social awareness campaigns
- **Body 2 — Negative effects:** addiction and screen time; cyberbullying; misinformation spread; reduced attention span and sleep disruption
- **Body 3 — Balanced use:** digital literacy education; parental and institutional guidance; self-regulation and time limits
- **Conclusion:** social media is a tool — impact depends on mindful use; call for responsible digital citizenship
- Linking devices: **However** (contrast), **Moreover** (addition), **Therefore** (result), **In conclusion** (wrap-up)
- Other SLM topics for practice: gender equality in education, dowry deaths, toxic parenting, refugee crisis, marital rape

For Exam

Sample essay outline for “Impact of Social Media on Youth”: introduction with thesis, three body paragraphs (positive, negative, balanced use), conclusion on responsible use. Use linking devices. SLM provides multiple contemporary topics for ~300-word practice essays.

Unit Recap (from SLM)

- Topics: gender equality, social media, refugee crisis
- ~300 words; intro-body-conclusion; plan first

Unit 5: Report Writing Practice

6.5.1 Report Writing Practice

Theory

Report practice applies Block 5 report formats to realistic scenarios — employee issues, event reports, newspaper reports. Objective factual tone and correct format are essential.

Important Points

- Practice: memo reports (To/From/Date/Subject) and formal report sections
- Include: factual objective tone, five wh- questions answered, conclusions and recommendations
- Newspaper report: headline, byline, lead paragraph (inverted pyramid — most important first)
- Sample scenario: HR memo on Thiruvananthapuram outlet — training, transport, salary issues
- Memo format: Institution name → To/From/Date/Subject → Introduction → Body → Conclusion → Signature
- Separate facts from opinions; use active voice throughout
- Letter report practice: letterhead, salutation, body with findings, complimentary close
- Formal report practice: title page, executive summary, findings, conclusions, recommendations

For Exam

Report practice uses memo format (To/From/Date/Subject) for informal reports. Answer who, what, when, where, why. Objective factual tone. Lead with most important information. Include conclusions and recommendations.

Previously Asked Questions

- **Q187** (10 marks, Aug 2023, Oct 2025) ★ — Prepare a report for your college magazine on the Annual Day celebrations of your ...
- **Q203** (10 marks, Oct 2025) — Prepare a report for your college magazine on the recently concluded Talents Day f...

6.5.2 Integrated Exam Practice

Theory

Block 6 integrates all Blocks 1–5 for exam preparation. Model Question Paper pattern: Section A (objective), B (very short), C (short), D (long answers).

Important Points

- **Section A topics:** communication origin, grapevine, barriers, reading types, parts of speech, concord, tenses, email types, essay types, proofreading
- **Section B topics:** feedback necessity, skimming vs scanning, textbase, concord importance, summary vs précis, active listening
- **Section C topics:** oral vs written, cultural barriers, three interpretation levels, stative vs dynamic verbs, declining application email, abstract features
- **Section D topics:** *Open Window* analysis (10 marks), *Blessed Damoze*l analysis, barriers essay, letter report on outlet issues
- Long answer *Open Window*: Vera, plot, themes (childhood, chaos vs order), window symbol, ironic twist
- Long answer *Blessed Damoze*l: Rossetti, Pre-Raphaelite, white lily, love/grief/religion, imagery
- Apply Theory + Important Points + For Exam format while practising all sections

For Exam

Integrated exam practice covers Sections A–D from model papers. Long answers require literary analysis (*Open Window*, *Blessed Damoze*l) and applied writing (barriers, reports). Use Blocks 1–5 theory while practising Block 6 exercises.

Unit Recap (from SLM)

- Memo and letter report formats; five wh- questions
- Objective tone; inverted pyramid for news
- Apply Block 5 theory in all practice tasks

Quick Reference — Exam Essentials

Topic	Must-Know
Communication origin	Latin <i>communicare</i> = to share
Basic model	Sender → Message → Receiver → Feedback
Best style	Assertive
Informal network	Grapevine communication
Non-verbal studies	Haptics (touch), proxemics (space), chronemics (time), vocalics (paralanguage)
Barriers	Physical, psychological, linguistic, cultural, organisational, etc.
Reading types	Skimming, scanning, close reading, amusive, reading between lines
Close reading	3 steps; John Ciardi
Textbase levels	Linguistic, microstructure, macrostructure
Situation model	Text + reader knowledge → deepened understanding
Kalam essay	<i>Ignited Minds</i> ; dream 30 Sept 2001; five thinkers
Saki story	<i>The Open Window</i> ; Vera; window = symbol; childhood
Rossetti poem	<i>The Blessed Damozel</i> ; white lily = resurrection; love, grief, religion
Parts of speech	8: noun, verb, adj, adv, pron, prep, conj, interj
Articles	a (consonant sound), an (vowel sound), the (specific), zero (uncountable)
Sentence types	Assertive, interrogative, imperative, exclamatory
Question tags	Positive stmt → negative tag; I am → aren't I?; Let us → shall we?
Concord	Subject-verb agreement; 3 types; a number of vs the number of
Tenses	12 forms; non-conclusive verbs (know, believe, want)
Reported speech	Present → past; will → would; statement order for questions
Active/Passive	Object of active → subject of passive; be + past participle
Writing process	Plan, organise, draft, edit, revise
Summary vs précis	Summary = nutshell, no heading; précis = crux + heading, ~1/3
Abstract	≤300 words; keywords; self-contained
Father of Essays	Montaigne
Essay structure	Introduction, Body, Conclusion
Report	Who, what, when, where, why

Topic	Must-Know
Informal reports	Letter report, memo report
Proofreading	Final step; surface-level errors
Editing	Linking devices; ESL benefit

About the Author

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